

## ROBOTS OF DOOM INCORPORATED

(ROD Inc.)

# Board Report

## Premium Pet Snacks

*Can premium pet snacks be a durable business at 20 hrs a week and S\$5k to S\$20k, and does any version beat Club and Coach Desk?*

|                |                                                             |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reference      | ROD-BR-2026-003                                             |
| Date           | 8 October 2026                                              |
| Prepared for   | Caleb, Founder and Chairman                                 |
| Prepared by    | RIVET-CEO, Chief Executive Officer                          |
| Contributors   | SPARK-CIO, COGSWORTH-COO, LEDGER-CFO, BEACON-CMO, PROBE-CRO |
| Status         | For Chairman ratification (decision D-004 is pending)       |
| Classification | Confidential                                                |

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# 1. Executive summary

**The answer: premium pet snacks do not beat Club and Coach Desk, so we park the idea and run one small, free test.** All four robots who attacked it agree. It needs more hours (12 to 15.5 a week against 7), more cash at risk (\$S\$1.5k to \$S\$11k against \$S\$0.5k), and nobody has shown a customer who would pay. The licence is not the blocker. Four local brands already sell freeze-dried treats, and we have found no gap they leave open. The test costs you about 3.5 hours before 21 Oct. If it fails, drop the idea. If it passes, pet snacks stays a reserve and cannot replace Club and Coach Desk.

## What we recommend you do now

| Step | When      | What                                                                                                                                 | Who                    |
|------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| 1    | Today     | Decide: park with the small test (recommended), drop pet snacks now, or give it a full slot of about 11 hours.                       | You                    |
| 2    | By 21 Oct | Send the five licence questions to AVS from your personal email (see "The licence, in plain English"). The robots draft the wording. | You, with robot draft  |
| 3    | By 21 Oct | Run the price poll and 3 shop visits (see "The next two weeks").                                                                     | You, with robot drafts |
| 4    | 23 Oct    | Both tests pass: pre-order and quotes only, no stock. Either fails: drop it.                                                         | Board, then you        |

## The licence, in plain English

**The regulator is AVS (NParks), not SFA.** Our earlier setup notes said SFA. That was wrong for pet treats, and 04-setup-costs.md is now corrected.

| What you would sell                                                         | What you need                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Non-meat treats (fruit, vegetable)                                          | A "no meat" declaration from the maker and a S\$22 permit per shipment. This is the lightest route.                   |
| Meat treats from Australia, NZ, Canada, UK or US                            | No pre-approval. A vet health certificate and the permit.                                                             |
| Heat-treated meat from the EU or Japan                                      | An online self-declaration, a certificate and the permit.                                                             |
| Freeze-dried or raw meat from anywhere else (for example China or Thailand) | The factory's dossier approved by AVS, which takes an estimated 4 to 12 weeks. We doubt it is legal for some origins. |
| Making it yourself in Singapore                                             | An AVS licence (about S\$240 a year) and commercial premises. Home kitchens are not allowed.                          |

**Still unknown:** whether fish and insect count as "meat", and whether an importer needs an extra licence. Only AVS can answer. We drafted five questions for you to send.

## The best versions, in plain English

"Profit" means monthly profit at month 12 after costs, before your own time. All numbers are estimates.

| Version                                   | What it is                                                                 | Profit: good / bad case       | Your hours a week | Our view                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Freeze-dried meat from Australia or NZ | One protein, pre-order first. Cleanest legal route.                        | about S\$0.1k / -S\$0.6k      | 15.5              | Priced above what local shelves charge, with 4+ rivals. Needs S\$8k to S\$11k at risk.                          |
| D. Non-meat freeze-dried fruit and veg    | Import and resell. About S\$1.5k of stock.                                 | S\$0.1k to S\$0.6k / -S\$0.5k | 12 to 15          | Singapaw already sells it, so there is no moat.                                                                 |
| P. Athletics owner poll                   | Ask pet owners in your own network to pre-order one product at two prices. | up to S\$0.2k to S\$0.5k      | 3                 | Free and uses your one real advantage. We could not find a Singapore running-dog group, so the pool is unknown. |

None of these reaches S\$2k a month without 19 to 39 shops reordering. S\$4k and S\$6k are out of reach.

## How it compares with Club and Coach Desk

|                               | Club and Coach Desk                         | Best pet version                       |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Profit, good / bad case       | \$2.5k / \$0.3k                             | about \$0.1k to \$0.6k / negative      |
| Your hours a week             | 7                                           | 12 to 15.5                             |
| Cash at risk                  | \$0.5k                                      | \$1.5k to \$11k                        |
| Evidence of a paying customer | Not yet, but a named buyer (club treasurer) | None, and no named buyer or introducer |

## What we dropped, and why

- **Reselling other brands' treats:** margin is only about 23%. It cannot cover the work.
- **Making treats yourself:** needs licensed commercial premises. That breaks your no-lease limit.
- **Generic shop wholesale, online store, subscription, influencers, events:** nobody could say who the first ten customers would be or why they would choose us over four existing brands.
- **China or Thailand freeze-dried meat:** blocked until AVS confirms it is allowed.
- **Insect treats and a canicross business:** demand looks too small and unstable.
- **Vet-dispensed treats:** dropped, because we have no vet introductions.

## The next two weeks (3.5 extra hours, about 17.5 of your 40 in total)

| By     | What you do                                                                                                                                                                | Hours | Pass mark                                                              |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 21 Oct | Ask 10 pet owners among your coaches and friends to pre-order a 50 g pack at \$12 or \$16 with a refundable \$5 PayNow deposit. Fold it into the sessions already planned. | 1     | 4 of 10 pay a deposit, and at least 2 at \$16                          |
| 21 Oct | Visit 3 groomers or pet shops. Talk only. Ask what they cannot get, what they would pay, and whether they would take stock on consignment.                                 | 2     | 2 of 3 name an unserved gap and a price, and 2 of 3 accept consignment |
| 21 Oct | Send the five AVS questions.                                                                                                                                               | 0.5   | A written reply. If none comes, fish and insect stay out.              |

## Where the robots disagreed

- **BEACON** wanted a full 11-hour slot. RIVET cut it so it does not crowd out the main tests.
- **PROBE** ranked reselling other brands first as a zero-licence probe. LEDGER, COGSWORTH and BEACON blocked it on margin.
- **LEDGER** would buy under \$1k of samples. RIVET holds stock until a pre-order passes.
- **COGSWORTH** ranks the Australia/NZ meat version first on legality, but at 15 hours for what Club and Coach Desk earns in 7.

## Decisions we need from you

- 1 **Park with the small test, drop now, or give it a full slot?** We recommend parking with the test.
- 2 **Accept 3.5 extra hours, send the AVS questions, and take \$5 refundable deposits from friends?**
- 3 **Confirm that a pass keeps pet snacks a reserve** that cannot displace Club and Coach Desk.

These sit beside the open decisions in the last report (D-003: income target, which lead business, who you can ask). Neither report changes the other.

## How to read the rest of this report

- **Veto codes:** K3 demand stability, K4 legality, K5 path to customers, K6 margin, K7 time to profit. Each states what would clear it.
- **Round 1:** five robots each listed 10 versions with vetoes off. **Round 2:** four robots attacked with vetoes on. **Round 3:** RIVET wrote the synthesis.
- The full record follows, unedited. You do not need it to decide.

**What changed since the last report**

We found the licence authority was wrong in our notes, and corrected it. We also rejected three market figures that kept appearing in searches ("1.3M cats", "\$412M market", "20.5% growth"); the licensed-cat count rose from 41k to 111k because of licensing catch-up, not market growth. Assumptions A-031 to A-038 are added and A-013 is weakened.

## 2. Synthesis

Written by RIVET-CEO after reading every round file. Reproduced in full.

### RIVET-CEO: full synthesis

2026-10-08. S\$ are estimates (LEDGER r2, 20 hrs/wk). SPARK filed no round 2. Baseline CCD (Club and Coach Desk): S\$2.5k good / S\$0.3k bad at m12, 7 hrs/wk, S\$0.5k startup.

#### 1. Verdict: park it, with one capped no-spend test

All four round 2 robots say no pet version beats CCD. I agree: worse on hours (12-15.5 vs 7), cash at risk (S\$1.5-9k vs S\$0.5k) and evidence (no wedge, no named buyer or introducer). No ranked slot.

Not dropped outright: ownership passes K3, two licence routes are light, and the Chairman asked. Not a full slot (BEACON's 11 hrs): it crowds out the main tests. **Net +3.5 Chairman hrs, no stock, gate 23 Oct. Fail: drop. Pass: reserve only.**

#### 2. Best versions and income ladder at m12 (tests, not income lines)

| # | Version                                            | Survives / fails because                                                                              | S\$2k                       | S\$4k / S\$6k | Base / down                  | Hrs   | Cash at risk |
|---|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------|------------------------------|-------|--------------|
| A | AU/NZ freeze-dried single-protein, pre-order first | Cleanest legal path, 56% margin / S\$28 per 100 g sits above the S\$27 shelf ceiling; 4+ local rivals | 427 packs/mo or 19-39 shops | No / no       | -S\$0.1k to +0.1k / -S\$0.6k | 15.5  | S\$8-11k     |
| D | Non-meat freeze-dried fruit/veg import             | 67% margin, S\$1.5k stock / Singapaw sells it; no moat                                                | 349 packs/mo or 19+ shops   | Unlikely / no | +S\$0.1-0.6k / -S\$0.5k      | 12-15 | S\$7k all-in |
| P | Athletics owner poll, one SKU, two prices          | Our one advantage, free / pool unknown, no SG canicross group found                                   | No                          | No / no       | S\$0.2-0.5k ceiling          | 3     | S\$0         |

LEDGER r2 supersedes r1's "S\$2k by m9-12": r2 tested prices against the ceiling.

#### 3. Licensing in plain English: AVS, not SFA

| Route                                       | Needs                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Non-meat                                    | Maker's "no meat" declaration; S\$22 permit per shipment (TradeNet, 1 day)                                   |
| Meat from AU/NZ/CA/UK/US ("scheduled")      | No pre-approval; vet health certificate plus permit (UK beef excluded)                                       |
| Meat, heat-treated, EU/Japan                | Online self-declaration, certificate, permit                                                                 |
| Raw/frozen/freeze-dried meat, other origins | Factory dossier, 4-12 weeks (est.); K4 doubt for China/Thailand                                              |
| Make it ourselves                           | AVS licence S\$240/yr, about 21 working days, commercial premises only (no home kitchens; breaks "no lease") |
| Private label                               | Licensed maker holds the licence; Pet Axis MOQ/price unknown                                                 |

Always: English label with importer name and address, a company (Pte Ltd advised for liability; the dossier route requires a company number), AVS GIRO account.

**Unverified; Chairman sends via [www.avs.gov.sg/feedback](http://www.avs.gov.sg/feedback) (personal email, not work Outlook):**

- 1 Do fish and insect count as "meat or meat products"?
- 2 Can freeze-dried single-ingredient chicken from a non-FMD-free origin meet certificate item (j) and the Pet Food Assessment?
- 3 Does a company that imports, or only sells, pet treats need a Feeding Stuffs Act licence (the import page says registration is "not mandatory"; worst case S\$240/yr, a form not a kill)? A brand owner using a licensed maker?
- 4 Does the "complete and balanced diet" label clause apply to treats?
- 5 Is there a public list of licensed manufacturers and approved plants?

#### 4. Kills and vetoes

| Item                                                                 | Status                                          | Clears if                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Curated resale (23% margin)                                          | <b>Killed</b> , LEDGER K6                       | Distributor discount above 55%                                |
| Home or unlicensed-slot production; own kitchen                      | <b>Killed</b> , COGS K4                         | Licensed premises (breaks constraints)                        |
| Generic wholesale, Shopee DTC, subscription, influencer, events, NGO | BEACON K5                                       | 2 of 3 shops name an unserved segment and a price             |
| A DTC; Pet Axis private label                                        | LEDGER K7 (A -\$0.1k/mo at m12; B \$9k at risk) | 5 written shop commitments of 30+ packs/mo; MOQ 30 kg or less |
| China/Thailand freeze-dried meat                                     | COGS K4 conditional                             | AVS Q2 yes, or an AU/NZ plant                                 |
| Canicross business; insect                                           | PROBE K3                                        | Group of 50+ or 10 prepaid; 3 of 10 pre-order                 |
| Recall-proof treats; vet dispensing                                  | Dropped                                         | Vets: 3 warm intros                                           |

#### 5. Next two weeks (net +3.5 Chairman hrs over the 14-of-40 plan, so about 17.5 of 40)

Robots draft; only the Chairman contacts anyone.

| By     | Test                                                                                                                                                      | Owner                   | Net hrs | Pass                                                       |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 21 Oct | Two-price poll (\$12 vs \$16, 50 g, refundable \$5 PayNow deposit), asked of pet owners inside the coach and friend sessions already planned (A-017 pool) | Chairman; PROBE drafts  | 1       | 4 of 10 deposit, 2+ at \$16                                |
| 21 Oct | 3 groomer/shop walk-ins, talk only (small sample, directional)                                                                                            | Chairman; BEACON drafts | 2       | 2 of 3 name a segment and price, 2 of 3 accept consignment |
| 21 Oct | Send AVS questions                                                                                                                                        | Chairman; COGS drafts   | 0.5     | Written reply (none: fish/insect stay out)                 |

Gate 23 Oct: both tests pass, then stage 2 only (20-person pre-order, 3 exporter quotes, Pet Axis quote, no stock). Else drop.

#### 6. Dissent

- **BEACON**: wants about 11 hrs. I cut it.
- **PROBE**: ranks curated resale first as a zero-licence probe; LEDGER, COGS, BEACON object (K6). PROBE's bar is stricter.
- **LEDGER**: would buy under \$1k of samples. I hold stock until a pre-order passes.
- **COGSWORTH**: ranks A first on legality, at 15 hrs for what CCD reaches in 7.
- SPARK's wedges (allergy, senior, toy breed) are untested, not killed.

#### 7. Corrections

04-setup-costs.md: pet treats are AVS, not SFA (SFA/TradeNet text is for human food); no importer registration mandatory, \$22 permit per consignment; add route table, local licence terms, Feeding Stuffs Act conflict as open; Pte Ltd advised. assumptions.md: A-013 weakened: 4+ local brands and distributors exist, though groomer and vet coverage is unproven; AVS part holds for non-meat only. Never use "1.3M cats", "\$412M", "20.5% CAGR". Licensed cats 41k to 111k is licensing catch-up, not growth.

| ID    | Assumption                                                                                                            | Owner     | Challenger | Status            |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|-------------------|
| A-031 | Fish and insect are not "meat" for AVS                                                                                | COGSWORTH | PROBE      | Untested (AVS Q1) |
| A-032 | Importers and brand owners need only a Pte Ltd and \$22 permits; AU/NZ exporters name us importer and accept stickers | COGSWORTH | PROBE      | Untested          |
| A-033 | Buyers pay \$24-32/100 g, above the \$27 ceiling                                                                      | LEDGER    | PROBE      | Untested          |
| A-034 | Shops name an unserved segment they would pay for (Fatal, K5)                                                         | SPARK     | BEACON     | Untested          |
| A-035 | Shops stock an unknown brand and reorder; \$2k needs 19-39 shops                                                      | BEACON    | LEDGER     | Untested          |
| A-036 | Athletics contacts include 10 pet owners; an SG running-dog group of 50+ exists                                       | BEACON    | PROBE      | Untested          |
| A-037 | A local maker does private label at MOQ 30 kg or less, no licence for us                                              | LEDGER    | COGSWORTH  | Untested          |

| ID    | Assumption                                                                                              | Owner     | Challenger | Status   |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|----------|
| A-038 | The pet test costs +3.5 Chairman hrs over the 14-of-40 plan, and the poll fits inside existing sessions | RIVET-CEO | COGSWORTH  | Untested |

## 8. For the Chairman

- 1 Park with the capped test (recommended), drop now, or fund BEACON's full slot?
- 2 Accept +3.5 hrs over the 14-of-40 plan? Send the AVS questions, and run S\$5 refundable deposits with friends?
- 3 Confirm that a pass keeps pet snacks a reserve that cannot displace CCD.

## 9. Draft D-004

| ID    | Date       | Decision                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Proposed by | Dissent                                             | Chairman | Meeting   |
|-------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------|
| D-004 | 2026-10-08 | <b>DRAFT:</b> Park premium pet snacks; no ranked slot. One capped no-spend test by 21 Oct (net +3.5 Chairman hrs): two-price deposit poll, 3 groomer/shop walk-ins, AVS email. Gate 23 Oct: both pass, then pre-order and quotes only, as a reserve; else drop. Licensing is AVS, not SFA. Add A-031 to A-038. Does not change D-003 | RIVET-CEO   | See synthesis section 6. Vetoes: K3, K4, K5, K6, K7 | PENDING  | synthesis |

### 3. Meeting agenda

#### Agenda as issued

*Date: 2026-10-08. Called by the Chairman (Caleb). Approved: 10 runs, parallel within each round.*

#### Why this meeting

The Chairman asked the board to brainstorm around **premium pet snacks** (dehydrated or freeze-dried treats; "check what licences are needed for meat"). Pet food was one of the Chairman's original seeds, but in earlier meetings it was only screened, never worked up. Baseline to beat: **Club and Coach Desk** (S\$2.5k good case / S\$0.3k bad case at month 12, about 7 hrs/week; see `company/meetings/2026-10-09-ideation-2/synthesis.md`).

#### Question

Can premium pet snacks be a durable business at 20 hrs/week and S\$5k to S\$20k in Singapore? Which **version** of the idea works (product, species, meat or non-meat, import vs make vs private-label, channel), what licences does each version need, and does any version beat the baseline?

#### Constraints (binding, from `01-constraints.md`)

- Singapore. Capital S\$5k to S\$20k. About 20 hrs/week. Partnership-led selling preferred. Steady income in 6 to 12 months.
- Stay away from the day-job industry (modular and prefabricated buildings, construction).
- Founder strengths: athletics network, entrepreneurial friends, vibecoding, website knowledge, business knowledge. Physical products are fine.
- Demand must be structural, not a fad.
- **Income ladder:** say whether each version can reach S\$2k / S\$4k / S\$6k a month net, and when (label estimates).
- Already known (`04-setup-costs.md`, checked 2026-10-08): meat-containing pet food needs AVS pre-approval; SFA registration and TradeNet permits apply to food imports. **Verify and extend these with current sources.**

#### Phases

| Round       | Who                                                | Writes                           | Vetoes                                               |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Diverge   | SPARK, COGSWORTH, LEDGER, BEACON, PROBE (parallel) | <code>r1-&lt;robot&gt;.md</code> | <b>Suspended. Do not kill or reject any version.</b> |
| 2 Converge  | LEDGER, COGSWORTH, PROBE, BEACON (parallel)        | <code>r2-&lt;robot&gt;.md</code> | On                                                   |
| 3 Synthesis | RIVET-CEO                                          | <code>synthesis.md</code>        | n/a                                                  |

Each robot writes only its own file. About 700 words max per file, tables over prose. Numbers need a source URL and date, or the label "estimate". Never contact anyone or spend money. Web search is allowed and encouraged.

#### Round 1 task (vetoes off)

List **10 distinct versions** of a premium pet snack business from your **assigned lens**, in one compact table. Include 2 stretch versions that push on a constraint (flag them). Columns: # | Version (product, species, sourcing model, channel) | Buyer | Price and margin (est.) | Startup S\$ (est.) | Licences/approvals needed (cite) | Hrs/wk steady state (est.) | Reaches S\$2k / S\$4k / S\$6k? (est.) | Founder fit | Source.

Then one paragraph: which 3 versions you would most want tested and why. Do **not** read other robots' `r1` files first.

| Robot         | Lens                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SPARK-CIO     | Pain mining and analogies: what do Singapore pet owners complain about or lack (allergies, small flats, HDB-approved breeds, cats, senior pets, treat quality, trust after recalls)? What works abroad (freeze-dried, insect, fish-skin, single-ingredient, subscription) but is missing here?                                                               |
| COGSWORTH-COO | <b>Licensing and operations.</b> Map exactly what SFA and AVS require for each category (meat, fish, insect, plant-based, dehydrated vs freeze-dried vs baked; import vs local make vs private-label made in Singapore). Costs, timelines, who is the legal importer, labelling, shelf life, storage, fulfilment. Then versions that are easiest to licence. |
| LEDGER-CFO    | Unit economics: landed cost, wholesale vs retail margin, MOQ and stock at risk, shipping, repeat purchase, subscription. Which versions have the best cash cycle under S\$20k?                                                                                                                                                                               |

| Robot      | Lens                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BEACON-CMO | Channels and partners: pet shops, groomers, vets, pet cafes, dog-run groups, pet events, marketplaces (Shopee, Lazada, Carousell), Instagram and TikTok pet influencers, and the Chairman's athletics network (e.g. running-dog communities, canicross). Who sells it for us? |
| PROBE-CRO  | Evidence: Singapore pet ownership and spending data, pet food market size and growth, premium-segment trends, competitors (names, prices, channels), recalls and regulation changes, and any signal on willingness to pay. Label what is unknown.                             |

### Round 2 task (vetoes on)

Read `agenda.md` and **all five r1 files**. Attack the strongest versions from your lens. For each of up to 6 versions: assumption, severity (Fatal/Major/Minor), cheapest test. State vetoes you use (with codes K1 to K7 from `03-criteria.md`) and what would clear them. Give your own top 3 versions and say whether any beats Club and Coach Desk on the income ladder and hours.

### Round 3 task (RIVET-CEO)

Synthesis: verdict on whether pet snacks deserve a test slot, the best 1 to 3 versions, licensing path in plain English, kills, vetoes, income ladder, next-two-weeks cheapest tests (the Chairman's first talk-test pool), dissent, and decisions the Chairman must make. Draft D-004 as PENDING.

# 4. Round 1: diverge (vetoes off)

Each robot listed 10 versions of the idea from an assigned lens: pain points, licensing, unit economics, channels and evidence. Unedited.

## SPARK-CIO

2026-10-08. All S\$ figures are *estimates* unless a URL is given. Singapore-specific complaint evidence was thin in search (no Reddit/HWZ threads surfaced); pain below is inferred from structural facts and must be talk-tested.

### Facts that shape the pain (sourced)

| Fact                                                                                                                                                                                           | Source (checked 2026-10-08)                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HDB allows 2 cats + 1 approved-breed dog since 1 Sep 2024; cat microchip+licence mandatory from 31 Aug 2026 (now in force)                                                                     | <a href="#">NParks</a>                                                                                |
| Euromonitor: cat treats and mixers grew 20.5% CAGR over six years; about 94k cats pre-ban. The "1.3M cats by 2025" projection is a pre-ban extrapolation and looks inflated; do not rely on it | <a href="#">PetfoodIndustry</a>                                                                       |
| HDB dogs limited to about 62 mostly small breeds (toy poodle, Shih Tzu, etc.)                                                                                                                  | <a href="#">Home&amp;Decor</a>                                                                        |
| Trust gap: 2021 aflatoxin recall of imported Sportmix dog food in SG                                                                                                                           | <a href="#">NParks</a>                                                                                |
| AVS pre-import approval applies to feed <b>containing meat</b> ; "prior approval of source is not required" for feed not containing meat (confirm fish and insect status)                      | <a href="#">AVS</a>                                                                                   |
| Local manufacture needs an AVS licence (S\$240/yr) at <b>non-residential</b> premises; AVS does not license home production                                                                    | <a href="#">GoBusiness/AVS/licence-to-manufacture-and-process-feed-for-non-food-producing-animals</a> |
| Shelf prices today: freeze-dried S\$10-29 (Vital Essentials, Freeze Dry Australia), K9 Culture local S\$25 per pack                                                                            | <a href="#">Watsons SG</a> , <a href="#">K9 Culture</a>                                               |
| Insect pet food: Singapore firm announced SE Asia's first insect dog food; no established local insect treat seen                                                                              | <a href="#">Eco-Business</a>                                                                          |
| Market: S\$412M pet care 2023, 8.7% CAGR to 2028 (low-grade aggregator, treat as indicative)                                                                                                   | <a href="#">Gitnux</a>                                                                                |

### 10 versions

Ladder column = S\$2k / S\$4k / S\$6k net per month (est.). Licence column: "no AVS pre-approval" assumes non-meat; COGSWORTH to verify.

| # | Version (product, species, sourcing, channel)                                                                                               | Buyer                      | Price / margin (est.)             | Startup S\$ (est.) | Licences                                                               | Hrs/wk | Ladder            | Founder fit |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------------|-------------|
| 1 | <b>Allergy-safe single-ingredient</b> fish treats (dried/freeze-dried), dogs, private-label from Japan/Thai OEM; sell via vets and groomers | Owners of itchy dogs       | S\$16-22 / 35% wholesale, 55% DTC | 6-9k               | AVS pre-approval likely not needed if fish counts as non-meat (verify) | 12     | Y / maybe / N     | Medium      |
| 2 | <b>First-cat-owner starter treat set</b> (lickable fish purees, mini tubes), cats in HDB, OEM label, Shopee + pet shops                     | New HDB cat owners         | S\$9-14 / 40%                     | 5-8k               | Same as above; Churu is incumbent                                      | 10     | Y / maybe / N     | Medium      |
| 3 | <b>Senior-dog joint and dental chews</b> (green-lipped mussel, non-meat), sold under vet-clinic co-brand                                    | Vets, owners of 8+ yr dogs | S\$28-38 / 40% wholesale          | 8-12k              | Treats and supplements are in AVS scope; non-meat                      | 10     | Y / maybe / maybe | Medium      |
| 4 | <b>Toy-breed mini-treats</b> (3mm, low-calorie training bits) for HDB-approved breeds; monthly subscription                                 | Small-dog owners, trainers | S\$14-18; sub 50%                 | 5-8k               | Non-meat                                                               | 10     | Y / maybe / N     | Medium      |

| #  | Version (product, species, sourcing, channel)                                                                                                                                                              | Buyer                           | Price / margin (est.) | Startup S\$ (est.)                     | Licences                                                         | Hrs/wk | Ladder            | Founder fit      |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------------|------------------|
| 5  | <b>Insect (BSF/cricket) hypoallergenic treats</b> , dogs and cats, imported or co-packed                                                                                                                   | Allergy and eco-minded owners   | S\$18-26 / 45%        | 8-12k                                  | Insects probably not "meat" (verify)                             | 10     | maybe / N / N     | Low              |
| 6  | <b>Fish-skin chews</b> as rawhide alternative, dogs, import (Iceland/Japan style)                                                                                                                          | Chewers, aggressive-chew owners | S\$12-20 / 40%        | 6-10k                                  | Fish; verify                                                     | 8      | Y / N / N         | Low              |
| 7  | <b>Made-in-SG private label</b> : contract-pack dehydrated treats at an already AVS-licensed local kitchen, sold with "made here" claim                                                                    | Trust-seeking owners            | S\$18-25 / 50%        | 7-12k                                  | Licensee is the co-packer (S\$240/yr); we avoid our own premises | 12     | Y / maybe / N     | High (sales)     |
| 8  | <b>Pet birthday and gifting boxes</b> (dehydrated treat sets), B2C plus corporate gifts, entrepreneur-friend network                                                                                       | Gifting buyers, firms           | S\$35-60 / 50%        | 5-8k                                   | Non-meat contents                                                | 10     | Y / maybe / N     | High             |
| 9  | <b>STRETCH: canicross / running-dog recovery snack</b> (electrolyte-style, non-meat), sold through athletics and running communities                                                                       | Active-dog owners               | S\$20-30 / 50%        | 6-10k                                  | Supplement scope; verify                                         | 8      | maybe / N / N     | <b>Very high</b> |
| 10 | <b>STRETCH: "recall-proof" traceable treats</b> : batch QR with third-party lab results (aflatoxin, salmonella), premium positioning; includes meat freeze-dried from scheduled countries (NZ/AU/US/UK/CA) | Post-recall anxious owners      | S\$25-40 / 50%        | 12-20k (lab and meat MOQ push capital) | AVS pre-approval for meat; scheduled-country route is lighter    | 12     | maybe / maybe / N | Medium           |

### Which 3 I would test first

- #7 Made-in-SG private label.** It removes the import and dossier burden, gives a defensible trust story, and it is the only version where a licensed partner exists (K9 Culture-type kitchens). It uses sales strength. Needs a co-packer willing to do MOQ-light runs.
- #9 Canicross / athletics-dog snack.** It is the only version that uses the Chairman's unfair advantage (athletics network as channel). Small pool, so it is a beachhead and not a S\$4k business alone; pair with #1 or #4 for volume.
- #1 Allergy-safe single-ingredient via vets/groomers.** Real, recurring pain (allergies), repeat purchase, and a partnership channel (vets, groomers) that the constraints prefer. Cheapest test: 10 vet/groomer talk-tests plus one 200-unit pilot.

**Honest weakness:** none of these clearly beats Club and Coach Desk on hours (7 hrs/week) because physical stock, co-packing and Shopee fulfilment eat time. Ideas 5 and 6 are interesting for novelty but I cannot name a buyer who is not already served by Freeze Dry Australia or K9 Culture. The incumbents are plentiful at S\$10-29, so the question is whether any of them serve *allergic*, *senior* or *HDB-small* dogs well, which needs talk tests, not search.

## PROBE-CRO

*Checked 2026-10-08. Vetoes suspended. "Source? Date? Sample size?" Aggregator sites (Gitnux etc.) are anecdote grade and flagged as such. S\$ conversions from EUR are estimates.*

## 1. Evidence table

| Topic                | Finding                                                                                                                                                                    | Grade                            | Source (checked 2026-10-08)                                                                                         |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cat population       | 111,000+ pet cats licensed when the transition ended 1 Sep 2026 (66,000 in July; ~7 in 10 licensed then). About 41,000 at end Aug 2025. Fines up to S\$5,000 now enforced. | Gov-derived, news                | <a href="#">Malay Mail 2026-09-01</a> (page itself 403, read via search summary); <a href="#">NParks 2025-09-01</a> |
| Dog population       | 84,000 licensed dogs in H1 2024 (70,000 in 2019, +20%). No newer figure found. <b>Older than 12 months.</b>                                                                | Secondary                        | search summary of NParks/MND material; not re-verified at primary                                                   |
| HDB limits           | Up to 2 cats per HDB flat (plus 1 approved dog breed); 3 pets in private homes. Cat limit was relaxed in 2024.                                                             | Supported                        | <a href="#">Polypet 2026</a> (retailer blog, not gov)                                                               |
| <b>CONTRADICTED</b>  | "1.3M cats vs 465k dogs by 2025" (Pet Food Industry) is wrong by roughly 10x for cats. Do not use. Date of article unknown, likely old Euromonitor projection.             | Contradicted                     | <a href="#">petfoodindustry.com</a> (403) vs licence counts above                                                   |
| Pet food market size | EUR 132M in 2024 (about S\$190M, estimate), +3.2% CAGR 2024-29                                                                                                             | Industry, paywalled              | <a href="#">Statista via search</a>                                                                                 |
|                      | S\$150M in 2025 (Vulcan Post, "estimated"; unclear if all pet food)                                                                                                        | Weak                             | <a href="#">Vulcan Post</a>                                                                                         |
|                      | S\$185M in 2023; treats and toppers S\$28M; households spend S\$85/month on food; 28% of households own a pet                                                              | <b>Aggregator, anecdote only</b> | <a href="#">Gitnux</a>                                                                                              |
| Premium trend        | "Premium growth and price polarisation" defines 2026; relaxed cat rules and wellness treats named as drivers; e-commerce gaining on premium items                          | Industry summary                 | <a href="#">Euromonitor summary</a> , covers to Jun 2026                                                            |
| Fresh pet food       | Fresh/cooked is 10-20% of the category; PetCubes (2013) and BOM BOM (~10k customers, SFA-licensed 5,000 sq ft plant) sell via DTC subscription, vets, Pet Lovers Centre    | Journalism                       | <a href="#">Vulcan Post 2025</a>                                                                                    |
| Recalls              | Only Singapore pet-food recall found: Sportmix aflatoxin, Jan 2021 (importer Pet Station). No 2024-26 AVS treat recall found. <b>Absence of search hits is not proof.</b>  | Weak negative                    | <a href="#">NParks 2021</a>                                                                                         |

## 2. Competitors and prices (all retail, 2026-10-08 listings)

| Brand                  | Product                                                                                                    | Price              | Per 100g (calc.)    | Channel                          | Source                   |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Singapaw (local)       | Freeze-dried minis 40g                                                                                     | S\$9.90            | S\$24.75            | Polypet                          | <a href="#">link</a>     |
| Singapaw               | Freeze-dried waffle 120g                                                                                   | S\$15.90           | S\$13.25            | Polypet                          | <a href="#">link</a>     |
| Holuah! (made in SG)   | Single-ingredient freeze-dried 50g (kibinago / venison)                                                    | S\$9.75 / S\$13.50 | S\$19.50 / S\$27.00 | Polypet; exhibited at Interzoo   | <a href="#">link</a>     |
| Vital Essentials (US)  | Freeze-dried liver 2.1oz (~60g) / beef bites 2.5oz (~71g)                                                  | S\$10 / S\$16      | ~S\$17 / ~S\$23     | Watsons online                   | <a href="#">link</a>     |
| Freeze Dry Australia   | Chicken hearts 100g                                                                                        | S\$13.90           | S\$13.90            | Watsons                          | <a href="#">link</a>     |
| Kit Cat                | Freeze bites 15g                                                                                           | S\$3.67            | S\$24.50            | FairPrice                        | <a href="#">link</a>     |
| Taki Pets (made in SG) | Freeze-dried bulk                                                                                          | S\$11.80           | pack size unknown   | Lazada                           | <a href="#">link</a>     |
| K-Nine Culture         | Meat chews, tendons, "Tiny Little Treats" (claims local AVS-licensed facility, <b>claim not verified</b> ) | S\$6-15            | n/a                 | Shopify DTC, wholesale enquiries | <a href="#">link</a>     |
| Pawfect Treats         | Home-based handmade air-dried (Shishamo etc.)                                                              | unknown            | n/a                 | IG/DTC                           | <a href="#">Pawjourr</a> |

**Read-across:** the freeze-dried single-protein niche is already occupied by at least 4 local brands. Observed ceiling is about S\$25-27 per 100g retail. **No price above ~S\$27/100g found, so "premium" has a visible ceiling.** Pack sizes of 15-50g imply sample-size buying, not bulk loyalty.

### 3. Regulation (extends 04-setup-costs.md)

| Item                                            | Finding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Source                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Meat-containing treats, non-scheduled countries | AVS pre-approval of product <b>and plant</b> . <b>Heat-treated</b> products from EU/Japan-type (BSE-negligible, FMD-free) countries need only an online self-declaration. <b>Raw, frozen and freeze-dried</b> need a full Pet Food Assessment dossier (composition, COA, HACCP/ISO certificates, process flow, health certificate). Permit S\$22 per consignment, AVS GIRO account. | <a href="#">AVS guideline 21 Apr 2026%2021%20Apr%202026.pdf</a> (read in full) |
| Scheduled countries (AU, NZ, CA, UK, US)        | Lighter route per search summary; <b>not read in full</b> , unknown                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <a href="#">AVS</a>                                                            |
| Local manufacture                               | AVS Animal Feed Licence S\$240/yr, ~21 working days, <b>no home production in HDB or private homes</b> , needs approved commercial premises (URA/HDB/JTC and NEA approval). Formal HACCP not mandated.                                                                                                                                                                              | <a href="#">AVS 2025-12-12</a>                                                 |
| Personal parcels                                | Permit needed for any meat pet food, even online parcels. Meat-free hand-carry allowed to 20kg dry.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <a href="#">AVS 2025-11-15</a>                                                 |
| Labelling                                       | English; ingredients, manufacture and expiry dates, species, importer name and address                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | AVS summary via search (not read in full)                                      |

Implication: a home-kitchen dehydrator business is not licensable. Pawfect-style "home-based" operation looks non-compliant on the AVS wording (unverified whether they hold a licence).

### 4. Demand stability (K3 lens, no veto in R1)

| Test                     | Result                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Need older than 5 years? | Pet ownership: yes (84k dogs in 2024 vs 70k in 2019). Premium freeze-dried treats specifically: <b>unknown</b> , no time series found.                                                                      |
| Growth                   | Total category: slow (+3.2% CAGR, Statista). Cat segment: step-change from licensing and the HDB cap, but 2 cats per HDB flat caps growth per household.                                                    |
| Structural driver?       | Yes for ownership and humanisation. <b>Not proven</b> for freeze-dried format; may be a trend inside a structural market. Euromonitor also flags "price polarisation", which means a squeeze in the middle. |

### 5. Unknowns and cheap tests

| Unknown                                                                    | Cheapest test                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Treats market size (only aggregator S\$28M)                                | Ask Pet Lovers Centre, Polypet or a distributor for category share in the talk test |
| Repeat rate and willingness to pay above S\$27/100g                        | 20-person pre-order of one SKU at two price points                                  |
| Scheduled-country dossier burden                                           | Read the AVS scheduled-country PDF in full; costs 0                                 |
| Competitors' actual licence status                                         | AVS public list, ask                                                                |
| Pet Lovers Centre (69 SG stores per Wikipedia, date unknown) retail margin | Retailer interview                                                                  |

**Evidence-good-enough call:** ownership demand is solid enough for a cheap reversible test. Format demand and pricing headroom are not. Test with one pre-order SKU, not stock.

## BEACON-CMO

2026-10-08. All numbers are "estimate" unless a URL is given. Licence column: only what 04-setup-costs.md supports; COGSWORTH owns the detail. Pet-meat items need AVS pre-approval; all food imports need SFA registration plus TradeNet permit per shipment.

| #  | Version (product, species, sourcing, channel)                                                                      | Buyer                                                   | Price / margin (est.)                                      | Startup S\$ (est.)                         | Licences                                          | Hrs/wk         | S\$2k / 4k / 6k   | Founder fit              | Source                                                                                                                                                    |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Single-ingredient fish-skin or dried-fish dog treats, imported, wholesale to independent pet shops                 | Owner/buyer at independent specialty shop               | Retail S\$12-18; shop takes 35-45%, us 55-65% of wholesale | 6-10k                                      | SFA import reg; fish may avoid meat route, verify | 10-14          | Y / maybe / N     | Sales + walk-in outreach | K-9 Artefacts claims 150+ specialty shop partners ( <a href="#">link</a> , 2026-10-08)                                                                    |
| 2  | Plant-based baked/dehydrated dog biscuits (sweet potato, pumpkin), local contract bake, sold in dog-friendly cafes | Cafe owner/manager                                      | Retail S\$8-12; cafe keeps 30-40%                          | 4-8k                                       | Likely no AVS meat route; SFA/NParks check        | 8-12           | Y / N / N         | Walk-in sales            | Cafes with dog menus: Garden Slug, Sun Ray, Happenstance ( <a href="#">list</a> , 2026-10-08)                                                             |
| 3  | Counter-top "good dog" treat jar at groomers, any safe SKU                                                         | Groomer owner                                           | Retail S\$3-6 per piece; groomer 30%                       | 3-6k                                       | As SKU                                            | 6-10           | Y / N / N         | Walk-in sales            | Pet Safari runs grooming plus bakery ( <a href="#">link</a> )                                                                                             |
| 4  | STRETCH: vet-recommended senior/allergy (novel protein or fish) treat, vet dispensing                              | Vet clinic manager                                      | S\$18-30; clinic 25-35%                                    | 8-14k                                      | Health claims need care; AVS if meat              | 8-12           | maybe / N / N     | Weak (no vet contacts)   | 85 clinics islandwide ( <a href="#">link</a> not primary; estimate)                                                                                       |
| 5  | STRETCH: "recovery/trail" treats for running dogs via athletics network and canicross-style groups                 | Athlete/coach who owns a dog; run-club organiser        | S\$14-20; direct, 60%+                                     | 3-6k                                       | As SKU                                            | 5-8            | N / N / N alone   | Strongest network fit    | No Singapore canicross group found in search (2026-10-08). Specials Run since 2010 shows a dog-run audience ( <a href="#">link</a> )                      |
| 6  | Own SKU sold direct on Shopee/Lazada/Carousell, no partners                                                        | Online dog owner                                        | S\$10-16; 45-55% after fees (est.)                         | 5-9k                                       | As SKU                                            | 12-18          | Y / maybe / N     | Vibecoding for listings  | Shopee Live used by Pet Lovers Centre ( <a href="#">link</a> )                                                                                            |
| 7  | Event-only launch: 2 shows a year plus online                                                                      | Show visitor                                            | S\$12-18 plus bundles                                      | 8-12k (booths est. 1.5-4k each, unsourced) | As SKU                                            | 4-6 avg, spiky | maybe / N / N     | OK, weekends             | PetExpo 3-5 Apr 2026, 30k visitors, 150+ exhibitors ( <a href="#">link</a> ); SG Pet Festival 31 Jul-2 Aug 2026, 300+ exhibitors ( <a href="#">link</a> ) |
| 8  | Subscription box (monthly treat pack) driven by pet influencers                                                    | Urban dog owner, HDB/condo                              | S\$25-35/month; 40-50%                                     | 7-12k                                      | As SKU                                            | 10-15          | maybe / N / N     | Site build, no audience  | Pet influencers do brand deals ( <a href="#">link</a> ); audience building is penalised by constraints                                                    |
| 9  | Co-branded fundraising treat for adoption NGOs and charity dog runs                                                | NGO events lead                                         | S\$10-15; 10% donated                                      | 3-6k                                       | As SKU                                            | 3-5            | N / N / N         | Network, low             | Specials Run ( <a href="#">link</a> ); estimate otherwise                                                                                                 |
| 10 | STRETCH-free: white-label for an established distributor or shop brand                                             | Distributor buyer (K-9 Artefacts, Superpets 16 outlets) | S\$4-7 per unit wholesale, 25-35%                          | 8-15k                                      | Importer of record duties                         | 6-8            | maybe / maybe / N | Sales                    | Superpets 16 outlets ( <a href="#">link</a> )                                                                                                             |

**Partner economics (estimate).** Pet shops want margin and exclusivity; cafes want a menu story and low-risk sell-through; groomers want checkout revenue; vets want proof; event organisers want paying exhibitors.

**First 10 customers (version 1 or 3, estimates).** Visit 60 independent shops/groomers/cafes (about 25 hrs over 3 weeks). Expect 40-60% to take a sample, 10-20% to stock on consignment. That gives 6-12 accounts. Reorder from 50-70% of them by month 3.

### Which 3 I would test first, and why.

- 1 **Version 3, groomer jar** (and 2, cafe jar). Cheapest to test: 10 walk-ins with samples, near zero stock risk, the Chairman's CRM walk-in method applies directly.
- 2 **Version 1, independent shop wholesale.** Highest reach per hour if the product has an easy licence route; 150+ shops exist.
- 3 **Version 5, running-dog treats via athletics network.** Not income by itself, but the free talk-test pool: 20 athlete-dog owners can reveal willingness to pay and hand over referrals within a week. Caveat: I found no Singapore canicross group, so size is unknown.

**Honest caveat (my blind spot).** I assume shops reorder. Sell-through is the real number, and none of my conversion ranges is sourced. Who exactly buys this, and who introduces us to them? For versions 1-3, it is the shop, groomer or cafe owner, and the Chairman does not yet have a named contact.

## LEDGER-CFO

2026-10-08. FX US\$1 = S\$1.30 (estimate). Pack = 50 g freeze-dried (FD) unless stated. "Contribution" = price - landed COGS - packaging - channel fee - fulfilment; **excludes CAC, returns, compliance cost**. Fixed costs assumed S\$400/mo (insurance, accounting, tools; estimate, per 04-setup-costs.md ranges).

### Sourced price anchors

| Input                       | Value                                                                                                          | Source (checked 2026-10-08)                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SG retail FD treats 40-50 g | S\$9.90-16.00 (Singapaw minis 40 g S\$13.10 list; kiwi cone 48 g S\$16.00; Holuah venison 50 g S\$13.50)       | <a href="http://polypet.com.sg">polypet.com.sg</a> , <a href="#">Holuah</a>                                                  |
| China B2B FD chicken cubes  | US\$11-15/kg, MOQ 100 kg; FD quail US\$13-14/kg, MOQ 20 kg; FD ocean fish US\$35/kg, MOQ 10 kg (private label) | B2B marketplace listings via search, e.g. <a href="#">accio.ai</a> .<br><b>Unvetted listings; treat as floor, not quote.</b> |
| SG private-label maker      | Pet Axis: "low MOQ", FD range, ISO 22000/HACCP.<br><b>Price and MOQ: unknown, need quote</b>                   | <a href="http://petaxis.sg">petaxis.sg</a> via search                                                                        |
| Air freight China-SG        | US\$1.57-4.00/kg freight; US\$5-12/kg express                                                                  | <a href="http://tonlexing.com">tonlexing.com</a>                                                                             |
| Shopee SG fees 2026         | Commission 2-6% (non-Mall), transaction 2.18%, tech-support 5% (Feb 2026); total roughly 10-20%                | <a href="http://getonecart.com">getonecart.com</a>                                                                           |
| Retailer margin on treats   | 45-60% of MSRP (US data); independents 2.0-2.5x wholesale                                                      | <a href="http://wholesalehelper.io">wholesalehelper.io</a>                                                                   |
| Compliance cost drivers     | AVS pre-import approval for meat; SFA registration + per-shipment TradeNet permit                              | 04-setup-costs.md (2026-10-08)                                                                                               |

**Key CFO finding:** product cost is tiny (S\$0.85-2 per 50 g pack from China); margin is not the constraint. The constraints are (1) compliance cost for meat, (2) volume needed (250-700 packs/mo), (3) CAC, (4) stock sitting unsold.

## 10 versions

| #  | Version (product, species, sourcing, channel)                                                                           | Price / contribution per pack (est.)                      | Startup S\$ and stock at risk (est.)                               | Licences (cite)                                                                | Hrs/wk | Packs/mo for S\$2k / 4k / 6k net | Founder fit                                |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 1  | FD single-ingredient chicken/fish, dogs, China OEM private label, own site + Shopee DTC                                 | S\$13.90 / S\$9.40 (67%)                                  | S\$3-5k; 20 kg = ~S\$340 product + S\$1k packaging/design min.     | AVS dossier for China plant (meat) + SFA (04-setup-costs)                      | 8-12   | 260 / 470 / 680                  | Web, sales                                 |
| 2  | <b>Non-meat</b> FD fruit/veg treats (waffle/cone style), dogs+cats, import, DTC                                         | S\$13.10 / S\$8.30 (64%)                                  | S\$3-5k                                                            | SFA import only, if no meat (confirm)                                          | 8-10   | 290 / 530 / 770                  | Web                                        |
| 3  | SG-made private label (Pet Axis) FD, wholesale to shops/groomers                                                        | S\$7.95 wholesale / S\$3.55 (45%) at est. S\$70/kg        | <b>S\$7-10k</b> if MOQ 100 kg (2,000 packs, ~7 mo cover at 270/mo) | Maker holds licence; you may still need importer role for sub-inputs (confirm) | 6-8    | 680 / 1,240 / 1,800              | Sales network                              |
| 4  | Same as 3 but sold DTC at S\$15.90                                                                                      | S\$15.90 / S\$8.70 (55%)                                  | S\$7-10k                                                           | as 3                                                                           | 10-12  | 280 / 510 / 740                  | Web                                        |
| 5  | China/India dehydrated jerky/liver, cheap wholesale to groomers, dogs                                                   | S\$4.50 wholesale / S\$3.00 (67%)                         | S\$2-3k                                                            | AVS (meat)                                                                     | 6      | 800 / 1,470 / 2,130              | Sales                                      |
| 6  | Resell existing brands as a curated "treat of the month" subscription (no import)                                       | S\$14 / S\$3.30 (23%) at ~38% distributor discount (est.) | S\$1.5-3k, near-zero stock                                         | None if buying from licensed SG distributor (confirm)                          | 6-8    | 740 / 1,350 / 1,960              | Web, ops                                   |
| 7  | Fish skin / dehydrated fish treats, cats+dogs, SEA import, DTC                                                          | S\$14 / S\$8-9 (est.)                                     | S\$3-5k                                                            | SFA; AVS if meat-derived (confirm)                                             | 8-10   | 280 / 520 / 750                  | Web                                        |
| 8  | Insect (BSF) hypoallergenic treats, dogs, import, DTC                                                                   | S\$16 / S\$9 (est.)                                       | S\$3-5k                                                            | SFA/AVS category unclear                                                       | 8-10   | 270 / 500 / 720                  | Web                                        |
| 9  | <b>STRETCH (licensing):</b> own small-batch baked/dehydrated treats from rented licensed kitchen slots                  | S\$12 / S\$6 (est.)                                       | S\$6-10k (dehydrator, kitchen fees, licence)                       | SFA food-factory style licence (COGSWORTH to confirm)                          | 15-20  | 330 / 600 / 900                  | Weak on hands-on time                      |
| 10 | <b>STRETCH (hours/niche):</b> functional "recovery" treats for canicross/running dogs via athletics network, S\$20/pack | S\$20 / S\$13 (est.)                                      | S\$4-6k                                                            | As 1/2, plus claims risk                                                       | 8-10   | 200 / 340 / 480                  | <b>Athletics network, but small market</b> |

Packs/mo = (target + S\$400 fixed) / contribution. Subscribers needed at 1 pack/mo per customer: roughly equal to the packs figure, so S\$2k on #1 = ~260 active subscribers; at 8% monthly churn (estimate) that is ~20 new customers a month just to stand still.

## Cash cycle and risks

| Item                 | Base case                                               | Downside                                                                                 |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cash tied up (#1/#2) | Order 20 kg, sell through in 3-4 mo; payback ~month 4-6 | Products fail talk test; S\$1.5-3k stock expires (FD shelf life 12-24 mo, estimate)      |
| Cash tied up (#3/#4) | S\$7k MOQ locked; payback ~month 9-12                   | Stock at risk equals 35-50% of the S\$20k budget; <b>worst cash cycle</b>                |
| CAC (estimate)       | S\$5 via partners, S\$15-30 paid social                 | DTC at S\$25 CAC eats ~2.7 packs of margin; first-order payback fails on one-pack buyers |
| Per-shipment permits | Spread over 400+ packs, ~S\$0.10-0.30/pack              | Small repeated shipments erode margin                                                    |

## Which 3 to test first

- #2 non-meat FD fruit/veg import (or #6 as a zero-licence fallback).** Avoids AVS, small MOQ, S\$3-5k at risk, reaches S\$2k at ~290 packs/mo. Cheapest to prove price and repeat.

- 2 **#1 China FD chicken/fish**, but only after COGSWORTH confirms the AVS dossier cost; the 67% margin is meaningless if the dossier costs S\$3k+. Highest margin on paper, highest paperwork.
- 3 **#10 canicross niche via athletics network**. Highest price and fit with the Chairman's network. Tests whether a narrow premium story beats generic treats.

Honest base case: S\$2k/mo plausible by about month 9-12 for #1/#2; S\$4k and S\$6k need partner wholesale volume (#3/#5/#6) or 500-800 active subscribers, which I rate unlikely at 20 hrs/week within 12 months. Baseline (Club and Coach Desk) is S\$2.5k good case at 7 hrs/week, so no pet version clearly beats it on hours.

**Veto:** suspended (R1). Unknowns to quote: Pet Axis MOQ and price, AVS dossier cost, real distributor wholesale discount in SG.

## COGSWORTH-COO

Sources read 2026-10-08. AVS = NParks Animal & Veterinary Service. No fee or lead time below is mine unless marked "est."

### 1. Correction to 04-setup-costs.md

Pet treats are an **AVS** matter, not SFA. SFA's feed licence covers feed for food-producing animals [C]. I found no SFA step for imported finished pet treats. SFA only matters if we buy meat or fish ingredients ourselves for local production (est., unverified).

### 2. What each category needs (import)

| Category                                                                                  | Pre-import approval                                                                                                       | Per-shipment                                                | Source  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| <b>Non-meat</b> (plant, veg, probably fish and insect)                                    | None. Manufacturer's declaration "no meat", ingredient list                                                               | CCP via TradeNet, S\$22, 1 working day                      | [A] [B] |
| <b>Meat, from AU / NZ / CA / UK / US</b> ("scheduled")                                    | None                                                                                                                      | Health certificate from exporting vet authority + CCP S\$22 | [A] [B] |
| <b>Meat, heat-treated, from EU / Japan</b> (BSE-negligible, FMD-free)                     | Online self-declaration before arrival                                                                                    | Health certificate + CCP                                    | [D]     |
| <b>Meat, raw / frozen / freeze-dried, or any other origin</b> (Thailand, China, Malaysia) | <b>PFA technical dossier</b> from the factory: composition, COA, label, process flow, HACCP, licences, sample health cert | Health cert + CCP                                           | [D]     |
| <b>Beef</b> from non-BSE-negligible origin                                                | Not allowed                                                                                                               | n/a                                                         | [D]     |

- "Meat" is listed as beef, lamb, chicken, meat/bone meal. Whether fish or insect count as meat is **not stated** in the pages I read. A search summary said no, but that is an inference. Confirm with AVS before betting on it.
- Gelatin, collagen, glucosamine and chondroitin need an animal-or-synthetic declaration [B].
- Dossier lead time is **not published**. Est. 4 to 12 weeks, plus the factory's willingness to share documents.
- Registering as an importer on GoBusiness is "not mandatory" [B]. Needs a GIRO account with AVS and a TradeNet/Customs account. The Feeding Stuff's Act text says a licence is needed to import or sell feed [E]. That conflicts with [B]. **Ask AVS in writing**.
- The legal importer must be a registered entity. The PFA cover letter needs a company registration number and a recall contact [D]. **Use a Pte Ltd** (liability).
- Labels must be in English: manufacturer and importer names and addresses, ingredients, manufacture and expiry dates, directions, analysis [D].

### 3. What each category needs (local make)

| Item        | Requirement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Source  |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Licence     | AVS licence to manufacture, S\$240/yr, about 21 working days                                                                                                                                                                                                         | [F]     |
| Premises    | <b>Not</b> HDB or private residential. Needs URA/HDB/JTC permission and NEA approval. SFA says food processing establishments cannot make or store pet food [C]                                                                                                      | [F] [C] |
| Documents   | ACRA profile, layout plan, process flow, SOPs, labels                                                                                                                                                                                                                | [F]     |
| Implication | A commercial unit and a lease. This hits the "no lease" rule in 01-constraints.md. Est. S\$1.5k to 3k/month for a small industrial unit                                                                                                                              | est.    |
| Escape      | <b>Private label</b> through an AVS-licensed maker. Pet Axis (Singapore) claims to be the only SG private-label pet food producer and does freeze-dried [G]. The maker holds the licence. Whether a brand owner needs its own is unconfirmed. MOQ and price unknown. | [G]     |

#### 4. Ten versions (ranked by ease of licensing, easiest first)

Margins and startup figures are **estimates**. Hours assume steady state. Ladder = S\$2k / S\$4k / S\$6k net per month.

| #  | Version                                                                           | Licence path                               | Startup S\$ | Hrs/wk   | Ladder (est.)     |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------|----------|-------------------|
| 1  | Curated treat bundles or subscription, resold from local distributors. No import. | None for us; distributors hold theirs      | 2 to 5k     | 8 to 12  | Yes / maybe / no  |
| 2  | Imported dried veg or fruit treats (sweet potato, pumpkin), dog                   | Non-meat: declaration + CCP                | 4 to 8k     | 8 to 10  | Yes / maybe / no  |
| 3  | Imported insect-protein treats (cats and dogs, allergy angle)                     | Non-meat IF insect is not "meat" (confirm) | 5 to 10k    | 8 to 10  | Yes / maybe / no  |
| 4  | Imported dried fish-skin or fish treats from Thailand/Japan                       | Non-meat IF fish is not "meat" (confirm)   | 5 to 10k    | 8 to 10  | Yes / maybe / no  |
| 5  | AU/NZ air-dried or baked meat jerky, own label via exporter                       | Scheduled: health cert + CCP               | 6 to 12k    | 10 to 14 | Yes / maybe / no  |
| 6  | AU/NZ freeze-dried single-ingredient meat treats                                  | Scheduled: health cert + CCP               | 8 to 15k    | 10 to 14 | Yes / yes / maybe |
| 7  | <b>Private-label freeze-dried</b> made by a local licensed maker                  | Maker's licence; ours TBC                  | 8 to 15k    | 10 to 14 | Yes / yes / maybe |
| 8  | EU/Japan heat-treated meat treats                                                 | Self-declaration + CCP                     | 8 to 12k    | 10 to 12 | Yes / maybe / no  |
| 9  | <b>Stretch (licence):</b> freeze-dried raw from Thailand/China                    | PFA dossier, 4 to 12 weeks est.            | 10 to 18k   | 12 to 16 | Yes / yes / maybe |
| 10 | <b>Stretch (lease and hours):</b> own dehydrate/freeze-dry kitchen in a JTC unit  | AVS S\$240 + premises approvals            | 15 to 25k   | 25+      | Yes / yes / maybe |

All ladder and margin figures are my estimates. LEDGER owns margins.

#### 5. Recurring operating load (est.)

Per shipment: TradeNet declaration and documents about 1.5 hrs; one or two shipments a month. Support, orders and packing: 3 to 6 hrs/wk at 100 orders a month. Storage: dry goods in a spare room are fine, freeze-dried is shelf-stable but sensitive to humidity. Shelf life and sealing (oxygen absorbers, barrier pouches) come from the maker.

#### 6. Which three I would test first

- 1 **#6 (AU/NZ freeze-dried) or #7 (private-label freeze-dried):** premium story, a legal path with no dossier (scheduled origin) or no licence for us (local maker), and the only versions that plausibly reach S\$4k.
- 2 **#1 (curated bundles):** zero licence risk and a fast demand probe in the athletics and dog-owner network, before any inventory.
- 3 **#3 or #4 (insect or fish):** only if AVS confirms in writing that they are non-meat. That would make them the cheapest regulated import.

Chairman action (a form and an email, not a blocker): ask AVS whether fish, insect and brand-owner selling need a licence or registration.

#### Sources

- [A] <https://avs.nparks.gov.sg/pets/importing-exporting-a-pet/import/pet-food/> (2026-10-08)
- [B] <https://avs.nparks.gov.sg/businesses/commercial-importers-exporters/animal-feed/importing-pet-food> (2026-10-08)
- [C] <https://www.sfa.gov.sg/food-manufacturing-storage/licence-registration/application-process-fees-for-licence-to-manufacture-and-process-animal-feed> (2026-10-08)
- [D] AVS Guidelines for importing pet food, non-scheduled countries, 21 Apr 2026: [https://isomer-user-content.by.gov.sg/30/b3ab79c4-5fdd-4c77-a49f-68e72d1e80ba/Guidelines%20for%20importing%20pet%20food%20\(Non-scheduled%20Countries\)%2021%20Apr%202026.pdf](https://isomer-user-content.by.gov.sg/30/b3ab79c4-5fdd-4c77-a49f-68e72d1e80ba/Guidelines%20for%20importing%20pet%20food%20(Non-scheduled%20Countries)%2021%20Apr%202026.pdf) (read 2026-10-08)
- [E] Feeding Stuffs Act 1965: <https://sso.agc.gov.sg/Act/FSA1965> (search snippet only, 2026-10-08)
- [F] <https://avs.nparks.gov.sg/businesses/other-businesses/pet-animal-feed-producers/licence-to-manufacture-and-process-feed/> (2026-10-08)
- [G] Pet Axis, via search result (company claim, not verified), 2026-10-08

## 5. Round 2: attack (vetoes on)

LEDGER, COGSWORTH, PROBE and BEACON attacked the strongest versions and compared them with Club and Coach Desk. Unedited.

### PROBE-CRO

2026-10-08. "Source? Date? Sample size?" Sources checked today: AVS import page, HDB rules search, r1 files.

#### 1. Claim audit

| Claim (who)                                                                                                  | Verdict                            | Why / source                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Treats need "SFA registration plus TradeNet" (agenda, LEDGER #2, BEACON header)                              | <b>Contradicted</b>                | AVS matter. Importer registration "not mandatory"; a CCP (S\$22) is needed per consignment ( <a href="#">AVS</a> , 2026-10-08; COGS [B][C]). Fix 04-setup-costs.md. |
| Fish and insect are "non-meat" (SPARK #1/#5, COGS #3/#4, LEDGER #7/#8, BEACON #1)                            | <b>Unsupported</b>                 | AVS page does not define "meat" or mention fish or insect (2026-10-08). Chairman action: written AVS query.                                                         |
| Scheduled-country (AU/NZ/CA/UK/US) meat needs no source pre-approval, only a health certificate (COGS #5/#6) | <b>Supported</b>                   | Same AVS page. I tried to break it and couldn't. Dossier route is for non-scheduled origins only.                                                                   |
| LEDGER #1 DTC S\$13.90/50g, #4 S\$15.90/50g, #10 S\$20/pack                                                  | <b>Unsupported</b>                 | = S\$27.8, S\$31.8, S\$40 per 100g. Highest observed shelf price is about S\$27/100g (my r1). Every packs-per-month figure rests on these.                          |
| LEDGER China FD cost S\$0.85-2/pack, 67% margin                                                              | <b>Unsupported</b>                 | Unvetted B2B listings. China is non-scheduled, so the dossier applies; LEDGER's "S\$3k+" dossier cost has no source.                                                |
| LEDGER retailer margin 45-60%                                                                                | <b>Unsupported for SG</b>          | US blog. LEDGER #6 resale at 23% already fails K6.                                                                                                                  |
| Pet Axis "only SG private-label producer", low MOQ (COGS, LEDGER #3)                                         | <b>Unsupported</b>                 | Company claim via search. Price and MOQ unknown.                                                                                                                    |
| SPARK "cat treats 20.5% CAGR"; "94k cats"                                                                    | <b>Blocked</b>                     | Same PetfoodIndustry article whose 1.3M cats I contradicted.                                                                                                        |
| SPARK S\$412M vs my Gitnux S\$185M                                                                           | <b>Blocked (both)</b>              | Aggregator, different scopes, same site. Statista EUR132M is the best number (paywalled).                                                                           |
| BEACON "85 clinics"                                                                                          | <b>Unsupported</b>                 | Cited to a cafe tag page.                                                                                                                                           |
| BEACON 40-60% take samples, 10-20% stock; K-9 Artefacts "150+ shops"                                         | <b>Unsupported / company claim</b> | BEACON admits unsourced. recordowl is a directory.                                                                                                                  |
| HDB: 2 cats and 1 approved dog; 62 breeds                                                                    | <b>Supported (retail/media)</b>    | Several 2026 guides; no HDB primary read.                                                                                                                           |

#### 2. Version attack (up to 6)

| Version                                                          | Assumption                                                 | Sev.                          | Cheapest test                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| FD single-ingredient meat, AU/NZ (COGS #6)                       | Buyers pay above the S\$27/100g ceiling vs 4+ local brands | Major                         | Two-price pre-order (section 5)                  |
| China FD chicken/fish (LEDGER #1)                                | Dossier is cheap and the plant will share documents        | Major                         | Ask a distributor; no spend                      |
| Private label, SG maker (SPARK #7, LEDGER #3)                    | MOQ is light and brand owner needs no licence              | Major                         | Written quote and AVS query                      |
| Fish/insect imports (COGS #3/#4)                                 | AVS treats them as non-meat                                | Major (Fatal if wrong)        | Written AVS query                                |
| Canicross/recovery (SPARK #9, LEDGER #10, BEACON #5)             | A paying SG dog-runner pool exists                         | <b>Fatal as sole business</b> | Name an SG group and its size; BEACON found none |
| Groomer/cafe jar, curated resale (BEACON #3, COGS #1, LEDGER #6) | Sell-through and reorder; 23% margin clears K6             | Major                         | 10 walk-ins, consignment ask                     |

3. Demand stability (K3)

| Test               | Result                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Need over 5 years? | Ownership: yes (84k licensed dogs 2024 vs 70k in 2019; r1). Premium freeze-dried format: <b>unknown, no time series.</b>                                                                                                               |
| Trap               | Licensed cats 41k (Aug 2025) to 111k (Sep 2026) is <b>compulsory licensing catching up with existing cats</b> , not new demand. Dogs: 84k licensed vs 114k Euromonitor 2023 (search result, unverified). Do not read either as growth. |
| Driver             | Structural for ownership and treats. Format may be a trend; Euromonitor flags price polarisation (squeeze in the middle).                                                                                                              |
| Verdict            | <b>Category passes K3. Specific versions below do not yet.</b>                                                                                                                                                                         |

4. Vetoes and blocks

| Use         | Target                                      | Clears if                                                                            |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| K3 (narrow) | Canicross/recovery as a business            | A named SG running-dog group of 50+ members (estimate) or 10 owners prepay           |
| K3 (narrow) | Insect treats                               | A local insect treat seller with a 12-month sales trail, or 3 of 10 owners pre-order |
| Block       | All claims marked Unsupported/Blocked above | Source or "estimate" label                                                           |
| Block       | "SFA registration" in setup costs           | Corrected to AVS                                                                     |
| Not used    | Whole category, FD meat, private label      | Ownership demand passes my tests                                                     |

5. My top 3, and versus Club and Coach Desk

- 1 **Curated resale of licensed SG-distributor SKUs** (zero licence). Weak margin (23%), fast demand probe.
- 2 **AU/NZ FD single-ingredient meat**: legal path is clear; price is the open question.
- 3 **SG private label**, if MOQ and licence quotes arrive light.

No pet version beats CCD. Hours 8-14 vs 7. LEDGER's own base case is S\$2k by month 9-12 vs CCD S\$2.5k. S\$4k and S\$6k need wholesale volume LEDGER rates unlikely. Pet snacks deserve at most a cheap test slot, not the lead.

6. Cheapest talk test (about 5 hrs, two weeks; estimates)

Clash: ideation-2 tests already use about 14 of the Chairman's hours; this fits only if run alongside the same contacts.

| Part                                                                  | Action                                                                                                                                          | Pass mark                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Owners (10, from athletics contacts and friends who own dogs/cats) | Show one concept (single-ingredient FD, 50g). Half see S\$12 (S\$24/100g), half S\$16 (S\$32/100g). Ask for a refundable S\$5 deposit by PayNow | 4 of 10 deposit, and at least 2 at S\$16. Else price ceiling holds |
| B. Stockists (5 groomers/independent shops, walk-in)                  | Ask: "Would you stock this on consignment?" Ask category share and wholesale discount                                                           | 2 of 5 agree in writing or by message                              |
| C. Admin (no spend)                                                   | Written AVS query on fish, insect, brand-owner licence; one SG distributor quote                                                                | Answers in writing                                                 |

Pass A and B (03-criteria Stage C talk test plus one other) and the idea earns a landing-page test; fail either and drop it.

BEACON-CMO

2026-10-08. All conversion and sell-through figures are **estimates** unless a source is named. I cut my own R1 ranges roughly in half because my blind spot is overestimating conversion and partner enthusiasm.

1. Bottom line

Is there a differentiated angle? Not one I can evidence. PROBE found at least 4 local freeze-dried brands: Singapaw, Holuah, Taki Pets and K-Nine Culture. Their prices sit at S\$10-16 per 40-50 g pack and they sell through Polypet, Watsons, FairPrice and Lazada (PROBE r1, 2026-10-08). A new freeze-dried single-protein SKU is the fifth entrant with no reason for a shop to drop an existing brand. The "premium" ceiling is about S\$27/100 g (PROBE), so there is no price-led wedge either.

The only wedges named in R1 are hypotheses with no demand evidence:

| Wedge                                                              | Evidence it is real pain                                                 | Status                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Allergy or senior dog (SPARK #1, #3)                               | None. SPARK says Singapore complaint data was "thin"                     | Untested                |
| Toy-breed mini bits for HDB-approved breeds (SPARK #4)             | None. Sizes of 15-40 g already exist (Kit Cat 15 g, Singapaw minis 40 g) | Untested, partly served |
| Canicross or running-dog recovery (SPARK #9, LEDGER #10, my R1 #5) | I found no Singapore canicross group                                     | Unknown pool size       |
| "Recall-proof" traceable treats (SPARK #10)                        | One recall in 5 years (Sportmix, 2021)                                   | Weak; S\$12-20k at risk |

## 2. Attack on the strongest versions

| Version                                                                    | Assumption                           | Severity                             | Why                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Cheapest test                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Groomer/cafe counter jar (my R1 #3, #2)                                    | Shops stock an unknown brand         | Major                                | Groomers earn little per jar. At S\$3-6 per piece and 30% margin, a groomer makes S\$20-40 a month per jar (estimate). They are already pitched by distributors.                                                                                                           | 10 walk-ins with samples, ask for consignment                               |
| Independent-shop wholesale (R1 #1, LEDGER #3, #5)                          | 150+ shops will stock us             | Fatal for S\$2k                      | The 150+ figure is K-9 Artefacts' own claim (recordowl, unverified). At LEDGER's S\$3.55 contribution, S\$2k needs about 680 packs a month. At 10-15 packs per shop per month that is <b>45-68 active accounts</b> , or a third to half of the whole independent universe. | Ask 5 shop owners their monthly sell-through for the slowest SKU they carry |
| Shopee/Lazada DTC or subscription (LEDGER #1, #2, #4; SPARK #4; R1 #6, #8) | Audience arrives without a big spend | Major                                | A new brand competes with 4+ listings. CAC S\$15-30 (LEDGER est.) eats 2-3 packs of margin. The constraints penalise audience building.                                                                                                                                    | 20-person pre-order at two prices                                           |
| Vet dispensing (SPARK #3, R1 #4)                                           | Vets co-brand a no-name              | Major                                | I have no vet contact. Vets want proof, and health claims need AVS care.                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 3 vet warm intros or drop                                                   |
| Athletics-network dog snack (R1 #5, SPARK #9)                              | Enough athlete-dog owners exist      | Minor as a test, Fatal as a business | It is the only channel where the Chairman has real access. Pool size is unknown and likely under 100 buyers (estimate).                                                                                                                                                    | Ask 20 athletics contacts: own a dog? would pre-order at S\$20?             |
| Curated resale/subscription (LEDGER #6, COGSWORTH #1)                      | Distributor discount leaves margin   | Major                                | LEDGER's own contribution is 23%, below the 30% K6 floor. No brand story at all.                                                                                                                                                                                           | Distributor price list request                                              |

## 3. First 10 customers, honest version

| Step | Action                                                                    | Hours | Conversion (estimate, halved) | Result              |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------|---------------------|
| 1    | Walk into 60 groomers, cafes, independent shops with samples (CRM method) | 25    | 25-40% take a sample          | 15-24               |
| 2    | Ask for consignment or a first order                                      | 5     | 5-10% of 60 say yes           | <b>3-6 accounts</b> |
| 3    | Reorder at month 3                                                        | 3     | 30-50%                        | 1-3 repeat accounts |

So 10 *trial* accounts is reachable but takes about 120 visits (est.). That is roughly 50 hours before any real revenue. Ten *reordering* accounts is not credible inside the first quarter. Each account is worth about S\$70-100 contribution a month (est.), so 10 accounts is about S\$0.7-1k. The Chairman has no named shop, groomer or vet contact (their own open question in 01-constraints.md).

#### 4. Vetoes

| Code        | Target                                                                                                                    | Reason                                                                                                                                                          | Clears if                                                                                                       |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| K5 used     | Generic freeze-dried or dehydrated SKU via wholesale, Shopee DTC, subscription box, influencer, events-only, NGO co-brand | I can get trial accounts but cannot name why anyone reorders or why the shop keeps us. 10 paying repeat customers by month 3 is not evidenced without ad spend. | 2 of 5 shop or groomer owners volunteer a segment they cannot supply today, and name what they would pay for it |
| K5 not used | Athletics-network pre-order poll                                                                                          | Costs the Chairman about 3 hours and nothing else. It is a talk test, not a business.                                                                           | n/a                                                                                                             |
| K5 not used | Allergy/senior/small-dog niche as a hypothesis                                                                            | I cannot kill an unmeasured wedge.                                                                                                                              | n/a                                                                                                             |

I also flag LEDGER's K6 (curated resale, 23%) and K1 (\$7-10k MOQ lock for Pet Axis) as agreeing with my result; they are not mine to cast.

#### 5. My top 3 and the Club and Coach Desk (CCD) comparison

| Rank | Version                                                                  | Why it survives                                    | Income ladder (estimate)                                      | Hrs/wk        |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| 1    | Shop/groomer talk test for an <b>unserved segment</b> (ask, do not sell) | Finds out if any wedge exists, 8 hours, zero stock | n/a (research)                                                | 8 hours total |
| 2    | Athletics dog-owner pre-order, one SKU, two prices                       | Only unfair advantage; free                        | S\$0.2-0.5k a month ceiling                                   | 3 hours total |
| 3    | Groomer/cafe consignment jar                                             | Partnership-led, low stock risk                    | S\$0.7-1k with 10 accounts; <b>S\$2k needs 30+, month 12+</b> | 8-12          |

**No pet version beats CCD.** CCD is S\$2.5k good case and S\$0.3k bad case at 7 hrs/week (ideation-2 synthesis). The best pet case I can support is S\$2k at month 9-12 (LEDGER) at 8-14 hrs/week, with S\$1.5-3k of stock at risk and no evidenced wedge. S\$4k needs partner volume that I rate as unreachable inside 12 months.

**Recommendation:** give pet snacks one capped test slot (about 11 hours in two weeks). If step 1 finds no named unserved segment, drop it and put the hours into CCD plus the SME-site line.

**Who exactly buys this, and who introduces us to them?** Today: nobody named, and nobody introducing.

#### LEDGER-CFO

2026-10-08. All inputs **estimate** unless a source is given. Model: Python cohort sim, FX US\$1 = S\$1.30, fixed S\$450/mo (insurance, accounting, tools), spoilage 4%, Shopee/DTC fees 15%, reorder 40% of active customers per month, customer retention 85%/month. Steady state is about 3.3 packs per new customer per month.

**Verified today (AVS page, checked 2026-10-08):** [avs.nparks.gov.sg/import-page](https://avs.nparks.gov.sg/import-page) still does not define "meat" (fish and insect status stays open). Importer registration is "not mandatory". The fee is S\$22 per permit. Scheduled-country meat needs a health certificate and no pre-approval. Pet Axis MOQ and price: still **not published**, so version B below is an estimate.

## Version attacks

| Ver.                                            | Key assumption                              | Sev.  | Why it fails or holds                                                                                                                                                                                      | Cheapest test                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. AU/NZ freeze-dried (FD) meat, own label, DTC | \$S14 pack holds against 4+ local FD brands | Major | PROBE: observed ceiling about \$S27/100g. 50 g at \$S14 is \$S28/100g, so zero headroom. Contribution \$S5.74 (GM 56%) needs 427 packs/mo for \$S2k                                                        | 20-person pre-order, two prices, no stock                  |
| B. Pet Axis private label FD, wholesale         | MOQ 100 kg at \$S70/kg                      | Fatal | Wholesale \$S7.00 less \$S3.55 COGS gives \$S2.37 (GM 42%). \$S2k needs 1,034 packs/mo = 34 shops at 30 packs/mo. BEACON expects 6-12 accounts. <b>\$S9k at risk, stock cover about 7 months</b>           | Written Pet Axis quote (MOQ, price, brand-owner licence)   |
| C. China FD meat + PFA dossier                  | Dossier costs little                        | Major | COGS about \$S1.4, GM 68%, but the factory must supply HACCP, COA and process flow (AVS, 21 Apr 2026). Cost and time unpublished. If dossier consultant time is above \$S1.5k, payback slips past month 12 | Ask 2 OEMs if they hold an existing SG dossier             |
| D. Non-meat FD fruit/veg import                 | There is a wedge                            | Major | Contribution \$S7.01 (GM 67%), 349 packs/mo for \$S2k, stock \$S1.5k. But Singapaw already sells waffle and ice-cream-cone FD (\$S15.90/120 g, PROBE). No licence barrier means no moat                    | 10 shop talks: "would you list this at \$S6.90 wholesale?" |
| E. Curated resale subscription                  | Distributor discount about 38%              | Fatal | Contribution \$S0.26, GM about 20%                                                                                                                                                                         | None needed, killed                                        |
| F. Groomer/cafe jar (BEACON 2/3)                | Per-piece \$S4.50 wholesale scales          | Major | Contribution \$S2.22, 1,104 pieces/mo for \$S2k. It is a demand probe, not an income line                                                                                                                  | 10 walk-ins with samples (CRM method)                      |

## Unit economics (A and D; base and downside)

|                                  | D base                         | D downside          | A base    | A downside |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------|-----------|------------|
| New customers/mo (after month 4) | 40                             | 20                  | 40        | 20         |
| CAC                              | \$S10 (partners)               | \$S25 (paid social) | \$S10     | \$S25      |
| Packs/mo at month 12             | 124                            | 62                  | 124       | 62         |
| Monthly profit, month 12         | +\$S64                         | about -\$S450       | -\$S109   | -\$S579    |
| Cumulative cash, month 12        | -\$S9.5k (incl. \$S7k startup) | -\$S13k+            | -\$S10.8k | -\$S14.8k  |

To net \$S2k at month 12 by DTC alone: **about 195 new customers/mo (D) or 290/mo (A)**. At 20 hrs/week and no audience, that is not credible. Wholesale route: \$S2k net needs **19-39 reordering shops** (D/C margins) or 34-69 (B). At BEACON's 6-12 accounts and 20 packs/mo, net is roughly \$S0.1k (A) to \$S0.6k (D) a month (estimate).

## Veto

| Veto | Target                                                            | Numbers                                                                                                 | Clears if                                                                                        |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| K6   | E                                                                 | GM about 20% against the 30% floor                                                                      | Distributor discount above 55%, or drop it                                                       |
| K7   | A and B, DTC and wholesale                                        | A: -\$S109/mo at month 12 (base). B: needs 34 shops for \$S2k, base 6-12 shops, payback beyond month 12 | 5 written shop commitments of 30+ packs/mo each, plus a quote that cuts the MOQ to 30 kg or less |
| K7   | Any version whose break-even needs more than 100 new customers/mo | See table above                                                                                         | Pre-order shows CAC under \$S10 at 40+ buyers                                                    |
| K1   | Not used                                                          | Largest case B: \$S9k startup, inside \$S5-20k, but it is 45% of the budget on one unproven SKU         | n/a                                                                                              |

I do not veto C, D or F. They stay as cheap tests, not income lines.

### My top 3 (and the baseline)

| Rank | Version                                                                                        | Why                                                                               | Test cost                                         |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | D, or C if the dossier is cheap, as a <b>pre-order or consignment test</b> , never stock first | Best margin (67%), S\$1.5k stock at risk, reaches S\$2k only if 19+ shops reorder | S\$0 for talks; S\$300-600 for samples (estimate) |
| 2    | F, groomer/cafe jar                                                                            | Gives real sell-through data from 10 visits                                       | Under S\$500                                      |
| 3    | Canicross/running-dog snack, <b>as the talk-test pool only</b>                                 | BEACON found no SG canicross group; revenue pool unknown                          | S\$0                                              |

**Versus Club and Coach Desk (S\$2.5k good / S\$0.3k bad at month 12, 7 hrs/week, S\$0.5k startup):** no pet version beats it. Pet snacks are worse on every axis: hours (8-14 against 7), cash at risk (S\$1.5-9k against S\$0.5k), and S\$2k reached only on optimistic reorder assumptions. On the income ladder: **S\$2k is possible by about month 12 (D, wholesale-led, 19+ shops); S\$4k needs 600+ packs/mo and 40+ shops, which I rate unlikely at 20 hrs/week; S\$6k, no.** Base case: S\$0.1-0.6k a month at month 12. Downside: -S\$0.5k a month and S\$1.5-9k of stock written off.

**Fair to the idea:** margins are healthy (56-68% on import versions) and the compliance path for non-meat or scheduled-country meat is light (S\$22 per permit). The problem is volume and CAC, not cost. If the Chairman wants a physical-product test slot, D plus F costs under S\$1k and 3 weeks to learn the shop reorder rate.

Show me the unit economics or show me the door.

## COGSWORTH-COO

2026-10-08. Hours and S\$ are estimates unless sourced. Read in full this round: AVS scheduled-country guideline [S], non-scheduled guideline 21 Apr 2026 [N], AVS import page [P]. Search summary only: Feeding Stuffs Act [FSA]. SSO and GoBusiness returned 403.

### 1. Open r1 points: what is now settled

| Question                            | Finding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Status                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fish / insect = "meat"?             | [N] and [S] list "beef, lamb, chicken, meat/bone meal, etc". Fish and insect are not named, and "etc" means the list is open. No AVS page I could read defines meat.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>Unverified.</b> It only matters for non-scheduled, heat-treated fish or insect (e.g. a Thai fish-skin treat). Freeze-dried from non-scheduled origins needs a dossier either way. Scheduled origins need only a health cert. |
| Brand owner needs own registration? | [N] cover letter lists "importer" and "exporter <b>or brand owner</b> " separately. No registration is asked of the brand owner. AVS import registration is "not mandatory" [P]. The importer needs a company number, a GIRO account and TradeNet.                                                                                                                                                                  | <b>Likely no for an importer-of-record Pte Ltd. Unverified for a brand that only sells.</b>                                                                                                                                     |
| Licence to import or sell feed?     | [FSA] (search summary of the 2000 text): no import, manufacture or sale of feed without a licence, S\$240/yr. This conflicts with [P].                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>Unverified.</b> Worst case S\$240/yr and about 21 working days (AVS licence page, r1 [F]). That is a form and a fee, <b>not K4</b> .                                                                                         |
| Scheduled route (r1 gap)            | [S]: AU/NZ/CA/UK/US need <b>no pre-approval</b> . Each shipment needs a vet health certificate, CCP S\$22, 1 working day [P]. Cert item (j): country FMD-free for 6 months <b>or</b> process certified to inactivate FMD. AU and NZ are FMD-free, so (j)(a) should apply. Freeze Dry Australia is on Watsons shelves (PROBE), which suggests the route works. UK beef is out (UK not BSE-negligible, [S] footnote). | Read in full.                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

**New finding:** both guidelines require the label to show importer name and address and a "guaranteed analysis in a complete and balanced diet" (NRC/AAFCO) [S][N]. Treats are not complete diets. Imported stock may need relabelling.

## 2. Attack on six versions

| Version (source)                                                           | Assumption                                                                                                                                                | Sev.                                | Cheapest test                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. AU/NZ freeze-dried single-protein, exporter's label (my #6, SPARK #10)  | Exporter will name our Pte Ltd as importer, supply a vet cert, and relabel. I tried to break the licence path and couldn't, because [S] needs no dossier. | Minor                               | Email 3 AU/NZ exporters: MOQ, cert lead time, sticker policy |
| B. China/Thailand freeze-dried chicken or fish (LEDGER #1, my #9)          | Freeze-drying meets the PFA dossier and item (j). Raw freeze-drying is not heat treatment, and these origins are not FMD-free.                            | Major to Fatal (K4)                 | AVS question 2 below                                         |
| C. SG private label via licensed maker (SPARK #7, LEDGER #3/4, my #7)      | Maker's licence covers us; MOQ low. Pet Axis MOQ and price are unknown. LEDGER shows 100 kg MOQ locks S\$7-10k.                                           | Major (cash, not legal)             | Written quote from maker; ask whether they need us licensed  |
| D. Curated resale or subscription, no import (my #1, LEDGER #6)            | Distributors hold the licence. LEDGER margin is 23%, below K6's 30%.                                                                                      | Major (K6)                          | Ask 2 distributors for trade price                           |
| E. Non-meat imports: fruit/veg, fish, insect (LEDGER #2/7/8, SPARK #1/5/6) | Fish and insect escape the meat route. Scheduled origins avoid the question anyway.                                                                       | Minor if scheduled; Major otherwise | AVS question 1                                               |
| F. Groomer jar and canicross (BEACON #3/#5, SPARK #9, LEDGER #10)          | "Recovery" or "functional" claims stay outside supplement scope. Treats are in AVS scope [P].                                                             | Major                               | Sell plain SKU, no claims                                    |

**Home kitchen, or rented kitchen slots without the licence on that premises:** AVS does not license residential premises (AVS licence page, r1 [F]). K4 kill for BEACON #2 if baked at home, LEDGER #9 and Pawfect-style operations.

## 3. Weekly hours (estimate, vs the 20-hour budget)

| Task                                                        | A           | C           | D         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|-----------|
| Shipment admin, TradeNet, cert chase (1.5 hr x 2 per month) | 1.5         | 0.5         | 0         |
| Orders, packing, support (100 orders a month)               | 4           | 4           | 4         |
| Partner outreach and restock visits                         | 5           | 5           | 4         |
| Site, listings, content                                     | 2           | 2           | 2         |
| Finance, compliance, stock count                            | 1.5         | 1.5         | 1         |
| Sourcing, QC, supplier calls                                | 1.5         | 1.5         | 1         |
| <b>Total</b>                                                | <b>15.5</b> | <b>14.5</b> | <b>12</b> |

A freight forwarder who declares in TradeNet saves about 1 hr/wk at an estimated S\$50-150 per shipment. Not needed for K2.

## 4. Vetoes

| Code | Used?                  | Reason                                                                          | What clears it                                             |
|------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| K4   | Yes, conditional, on B | Chicken or fish freeze-dried from an FMD-endemic origin may fail cert item (j). | AVS confirms in writing, or the maker is in an AU/NZ plant |
| K4   | Yes, kill              | Home-kitchen or unlicensed rented-slot production                               | Licensed commercial premises, which breaks "no lease"      |
| K2   | Not used               | A, C, D, E all run under 20 hrs. A at 15.5 leaves little spare.                 | n/a                                                        |

## 5. Ask AVS (only official contact in the guidelines: [www.avsgov.sg/feedback](http://www.avsgov.sg/feedback); do not invent a named officer)

- 1 Do fish and insect ingredients count as "meat or meat products"?
- 2 Can a freeze-dried chicken-only product from a non-FMD-free origin satisfy certificate item (j) and the PFA?
- 3 Does a company that imports, or only sells, pet treats need a Feeding Stuffs Act licence, and does a brand owner using a licensed maker?
- 4 Does the "complete and balanced diet" label clause apply to treats?

## 6. My top 3 and the baseline

- 1 **A.** Cleanest legal path, plausible S\$2k by month 9-12 (LEDGER), 15.5 hrs.
- 2 **C.** No licence for us on LEDGER's reading, but worst cash cycle.
- 3 **D** as a zero-licence demand probe before stock.

**Does any beat Club and Coach Desk (S\$2.5k good case, S\$0.3k bad, about 7 hrs/wk)?** No on hours: 12 to 15.5 vs 7. On the ladder, S\$2k is the pet ceiling in 12 months, and S\$4k needs partner wholesale volume LEDGER rates unlikely. That's 15 hours a week for a result CCD reaches in 7. The one thing pet snacks beat CCD on is the athletics network as channel, and BEACON found no Singapore canicross group.

## 6. Assumptions register and decision log

### Assumptions register

Every load-bearing assumption the company relies on. If an assumption is **Killed**, every decision depending on it gets reopened.

Status: **Untested**, **Testing**, **Validated** (evidence linked), **Killed** (evidence linked).

| ID    | Assumption                                                                                                                                                | Owner         | Challenger    | Severity if wrong | Status   | Cheapest test                                                                              | Evidence                                                                         | Updated    |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|-------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| A-001 | Chairman can sustain about 20 hrs/week on the business (raised from 10 on 2026-10-09) alongside other commitments                                         | Chairman      | COGSWORTH-COO | Major             | Untested | Track actual hours for 2 weeks                                                             |                                                                                  | 2026-10-08 |
| A-002 | Partnerships (resellers, referrers) can deliver the first customers without a large ad budget                                                             | BEACON-CMO    | LEDGER-CFO    | Fatal             | Untested | 5 partner conversations per shortlisted idea                                               |                                                                                  | 2026-10-08 |
| A-003 | Tuition/enrichment centres pay about S\$150/mo plus setup for an enquiry-to-trial-booking front desk, despite SchoolTracs bundling WhatsApp from S\$55/mo | SERVO-CTO     | PROBE-CRO     | Fatal             | Untested | 5 talk tests quoting the all-in price; no source shows any vendor offering this front desk | Incumbent pricing is vendor-written (schooltracs.com, 23 Jul 2026)               | 2026-10-08 |
| A-004 | Client pays the WhatsApp platform seat on its own account and still buys (all-in S\$246-282/mo). If ROD pays, gross margin is 12% / -5% (K6 veto)         | LEDGER-CFO    | SERVO-CTO     | Fatal             | Untested | Quote all-in price in the talk test; offer a free-app manual pilot                         | Sleekflow pricing, checked 2026-10-08; Meta SG rate sources conflict, immaterial | 2026-10-08 |
| A-005 | One person supports 12-13 light WhatsApp/booking clients in 10 hrs/wk (about 1.5 h per client per month plus 6 h onboarding)                              | COGSWORTH-COO | SERVO-CTO     | Major             | Untested | Onboard one free pilot and time-log it                                                     | COGSWORTH r2 estimate                                                            | 2026-10-08 |
| A-006 | Coaches pay S\$500 setup + S\$49/mo against Vibefam (from S\$89/mo), Acuity and free Linktree                                                             | BEACON-CMO    | LEDGER-CFO    | Major             | Untested | Landing page + Stripe link to 10 coaches; count deposits                                   | Competitor prices sourced; willingness to pay unsupported                        | 2026-10-08 |
| A-007 | SportSG or sport associations will send a member list or mail the offer (the registry has 6,100 coaches but is not a referral list)                       | BEACON-CMO    | LEDGER-CFO    | Fatal             | Untested | Ask 2 associations to mail a member offer                                                  | Registry size sourced (SportSG); sharing unverified                              | 2026-10-08 |

| ID    | Assumption                                                                                                                                                                      | Owner         | Challenger    | Severity if wrong         | Status   | Cheapest test                                                                                                                                                 | Evidence                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Updated    |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|---------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| A-008 | Warm-intro to sale conversion is 3-8% (base), not below 3%. Below 3% means 330+ intros per 10 clients                                                                           | BEACON-CMO    | LEDGER-CFO    | Fatal                     | Untested | 20 partner-warm intros asking a S\$100 deposit                                                                                                                | All conversion rates are estimates (PROBE)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 2026-10-08 |
| A-009 | CNY 2027 hampers: HR buyers commit deposits by 14 Nov at S\$150+/box with at least 30% margin after fees and insurance (S\$300-1,500). Decide by 22 Oct                         | BEACON-CMO    | LEDGER-CFO    | Fatal                     | Untested | 10 HR asks + 3 packer quotes + insurance quote by 21 Oct; go needs about 3 buyers, about 60 boxes, net season profit of S\$1,000+ (RIVET threshold, estimate) | Box price claims contradict (S\$20-250); margin unsourced; deadline from patchandbagel guide                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2026-10-08 |
| A-010 | Buying sealed, pre-packed hampers needs no SFA licence for ROD; only repacking does                                                                                             | COGSWORTH-COO | PROBE-CRO     | Major                     | Untested | Written SFA query; use a licensed packer                                                                                                                      | SFA fined unlicensed repacking S\$2,500 (2024); sealed-pack case unconfirmed                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2026-10-08 |
| A-011 | The dementia kit SKUs (storage, large-print clocks, albums, contrast tableware) are non-device and need no HSA licence                                                          | COGSWORTH-COO | PROBE-CRO     | Major                     | Untested | Run each SKU through HSA's classification tool; wander door-alarms unconfirmed                                                                                | HSA device definition, checked 2026-10-08                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2026-10-08 |
| A-012 | Caregivers or day-care managers pay S\$80-250 for a non-device kit despite Dementia Singapore's own store and means-tested caregiver grants, and a named introducer exists (K5) | PROBE-CRO     | BEACON-CMO    | Major (near-Fatal for K7) | Untested | 5 caregiver/day-care calls; preorder 10 units of 1 SKU                                                                                                        | Dementia 74k to 152k projection (MOH); willingness to pay unsupported                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2026-10-08 |
| A-013 | Vets and groomers lack a distributor for non-meat treats, and AVS needs no licence for non-meat treats or accessories                                                           | BEACON-CMO    | COGSWORTH-COO | Major                     | Untested | Written AVS query; 20-unit consignment at 3 groomers                                                                                                          | Pet-product growth slowed 2025 (Euromonitor, secondary); AVS unconfirmed. <b>2026-10-08 pet-snacks meeting: weakened.</b> 4+ local brands and distributors already sell freeze-dried and non-meat treats (PROBE r1); AVS part holds for non-meat only. Groomer and vet coverage unproven | 2026-10-08 |

| ID    | Assumption                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Owner         | Challenger    | Severity if wrong                                          | Status   | Cheapest test                                                                                   | Evidence                                                                                                          | Updated    |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| A-014 | SUPERSEDED in part: Chairman raised hours to 20 hrs/wk on 2026-10-09, so the B2B-service income cap computed at 10 hrs/wk (\$1.7-3.2k/mo base, \$1.2-1.6k downside) roughly doubles. Still open: what \$\$/mo counts as steady income | RIVET-CEO     | LEDGER-CFO    | Major                                                      | Untested | Chairman states the \$\$/mo target for "steady income"                                          | LEDGER r2 and COGSWORTH r2 estimates                                                                              | 2026-10-08 |
| A-015 | The Chairman's employment contract permits a side business                                                                                                                                                                            | Chairman      | COGSWORTH-COO | Fatal                                                      | Untested | Read the contract before any invoice (open question in 01-constraints.md)                       |                                                                                                                   | 2026-10-08 |
| A-016 | Cosecs and accountants will white-label a PDPA pack rather than build their own, with liability kept low                                                                                                                              | BEACON-CMO    | SERVO-CTO     | Major (reserve idea)                                       | Untested | Ask 3 cosecs to white-label; lawyer read \$500-1,500 if it proceeds                             | DPO prices \$100-500/mo (SG Secretary Services, 2026-10-08)                                                       | 2026-10-08 |
| A-017 | The Chairman can name about 15 coaches/officials and 10 founder friends who will take a 20-minute talk test (BEACON's assumed counts, not confirmed)                                                                                  | BEACON-CMO    | PROBE-CRO     | Fatal (the first test pool)                                | Untested | Chairman lists names in writing on day 1                                                        |                                                                                                                   | 2026-10-09 |
| A-018 | CCD's limit is partner intros, not hours (20 hrs: \$2.5k/0.3k; 80 intros a month: \$3.7k), and CCD plus kits/awards/results hub fits in about 15 hrs and beats CCD alone. Never modelled                                              | LEDGER-CFO    | BEACON-CMO    | Major (decides whether #1 and #2 really beat the baseline) | Untested | LEDGER models CCD + kits + hub at 15 hrs; count intros 15 coaches and 2 associations can supply | LEDGER r3 rerun                                                                                                   | 2026-10-09 |
| A-019 | Friend referrals give about 3 site builds a month at \$1,200 + \$59/mo against freelancers at \$500-2,500, with at most 10 h selling per win, and the pool of 10 friends does not exhaust                                             | SERVO-CTO     | PROBE-CRO     | Major                                                      | Untested | Pre-sell 3 sites to 5 friends (studios, tuition, coaches) before building the template          | Price band sourced (Maple Tree, launchd 2026); referral edge unsupported; BEACON funnel gives 3-6 sites per round | 2026-10-09 |
| A-020 | Site upkeep stays at 3-5 h/wk at 10 sites. LEDGER's \$4.3k needs 18 care clients; SERVVO caps at 8; COGS assumes 25                                                                                                                   | COGSWORTH-COO | SERVO-CTO     | Major                                                      | Untested | Time-log the first 2 builds; one template; cap clients in the contract                          | r3 files conflict                                                                                                 | 2026-10-09 |

| ID    | Assumption                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Owner         | Challenger | Severity if wrong                         | Status   | Cheapest test                                                                    | Evidence                                                                                     | Updated    |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------|-------------------------------------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| A-021 | HR heads pay S\$3-4k per event or S\$1.5-3k per cohort for athletics-coach quality over S\$30-80/pax team building, from a new sole prop, at about 76 warm conversations a year for 1.6 events a month. Price floor S\$3.8k | BEACON-CMO    | LEDGER-CFO | Major (near-Fatal for the S\$4k+ ceiling) | Untested | Quote 5 friends' HR heads with a 30% deposit                                     | Price band supported (OneD 2026, vendor blog); "nothing like it exists" contradicted (PROBE) | 2026-10-09 |
| A-022 | Company-run, non-public corporate and camp events are exempt from the Public Entertainment Licence; public liability insurance runs S\$300-1,500/yr                                                                         | COGSWORTH-COO | PROBE-CRO  | Major                                     | Untested | Written SPF query; one insurance quote                                           | SPF page read; the Act and exemption list could not be opened                                | 2026-10-09 |
| A-023 | At least 10 paying school/club meets a year exist in Singapore and do not already use SA e-entry, Team Manager Lite or HY-TEK. At S\$150-675 per meet this is a door-opener, not an income                                  | SERVO-CTO     | PROBE-CRO  | Major                                     | Untested | PROBE counts meets on SA and school calendars; one free Sheets pilot             | HY-TEK US\$349-499, AthleticLIVE US\$29/meet (SERVO, 2026-10-09); meet count unsupported     | 2026-10-09 |
| A-024 | Club treasurers pay a 50% deposit on made-to-order kits and awards, with 48% margin against printer quotes                                                                                                                  | LEDGER-CFO    | PROBE-CRO  | Minor                                     | Untested | 3 printer quotes; kit-quote ask to 5 coaches                                     |                                                                                              | 2026-10-09 |
| A-025 | Parents pay S\$280 or more per child-week for coach-led holiday camps (ActiveSG holiday S\$36-54; SA S\$315/term). Coach S\$35/h and venue S\$100 per coach-week are unsourced                                              | BEACON-CMO    | PROBE-CRO  | Fatal at S\$150+ (PROBE)                  | Untested | Coaches put the S\$280 price to 10 parents; one track-hire quote; 3 coach quotes | Little Day Out 2026; SA brochure                                                             | 2026-10-09 |
| A-026 | Adult runners or seniors pay S\$30-35 per session or S\$99-199 per cycle via run crews, with no paid clinic channel (Healthier SG referral runs through free SportSG/NHG programmes). The run-crew form is unmodelled       | BEACON-CMO    | LEDGER-CFO | Fatal at S\$18 per session                | Untested | 5 run-crew leads; LEDGER models the run-crew form                                | Healthier SG about 960k enrolled (2026)                                                      | 2026-10-09 |

| ID    | Assumption                                                                                                                                                            | Owner         | Challenger    | Severity if wrong                               | Status   | Cheapest test                                                                               | Evidence                                   | Updated    |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------|
| A-027 | SMEs pay S\$900 + S\$50/mo for an NRIC/PDPA fix, and a retainer survives past the 31 Dec 2026 deadline                                                                | BEACON-CMO    | PROBE-CRO     | Fatal as a standalone, Minor as an add-on to #1 | Untested | Ask friends in the site test; 3 cosec or accountant calls                                   | PDPC deadline sourced; retainers unproven  | 2026-10-09 |
| A-028 | Customers who buy one offer buy a second from the same relationship without extra selling hours (the stack), and #1 plus #2 cannot both run at steady state (30+ hrs) | BEACON-CMO    | COGSWORTH-COO | Major                                           | Untested | In each test, count the second SKU's attach rate; pick one main line on 23 Oct              | COGS hours table                           | 2026-10-09 |
| A-029 | The Chairman's 20 hrs are evenings and weekends; weekday daytime is the day job (so no weekday camps or deliveries). See also A-001                                   | Chairman      | COGSWORTH-COO | Major                                           | Untested | Chairman confirms on day 1                                                                  | COGS r3 assumption                         | 2026-10-09 |
| A-030 | The CNY hamper gate on 22 Oct is not worth its 7 hrs at 20 hrs/wk. RIVET recommends dropping it; Mid-Autumn 2027 is the fallback. Related: A-009                      | RIVET-CEO     | LEDGER-CFO    | Minor                                           | Untested | Chairman ratifies the drop; reopen only if the corporate test finds 3 HR buyers for hampers | RIVET synthesis                            | 2026-10-09 |
| A-031 | Fish and insect are not "meat" for AVS                                                                                                                                | COGSWORTH-COO | PROBE-CRO     | Major                                           | Untested | Written AVS query via <a href="http://www.avs.gov.sg/feedback">www.avs.gov.sg/feedback</a>  | AVS page does not define meat (2026-10-08) | 2026-10-08 |
| A-032 | Importers and brand owners need only a Pte Ltd and S\$22 permits; AU/NZ exporters name us importer and accept stickers                                                | COGSWORTH-COO | PROBE-CRO     | Major                                           | Untested | AVS query; 3 exporter quotes                                                                | AVS import page (2026-10-08)               | 2026-10-08 |
| A-033 | Buyers pay S\$24-32 per 100 g, above the S\$27 observed shelf ceiling                                                                                                 | LEDGER-CFO    | PROBE-CRO     | Major                                           | Untested | Two-price deposit poll (S\$12 vs S\$16 per 50 g)                                            | PROBE r1 shelf prices                      | 2026-10-08 |
| A-034 | Shops name an unserved pet-snack segment they would pay for                                                                                                           | SPARK-CIO     | BEACON-CMO    | Fatal (K5)                                      | Untested | 3 groomer/shop walk-ins                                                                     |                                            | 2026-10-08 |
| A-035 | Shops stock an unknown brand and reorder; S\$2k a month needs 19-39 shops                                                                                             | BEACON-CMO    | LEDGER-CFO    | Major                                           | Untested | Consignment ask at the walk-ins                                                             | LEDGER r2 estimate                         | 2026-10-08 |

| ID    | Assumption                                                                                              | Owner      | Challenger    | Severity if wrong | Status   | Cheapest test                                         | Evidence                  | Updated    |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|---------------|-------------------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------|
| A-036 | The athletics network includes 10 pet owners, and a Singapore running-dog group of 50+ exists           | BEACON-CMO | PROBE-CRO     | Major             | Untested | Chairman polls own contacts; no group found by BEACON |                           | 2026-10-08 |
| A-037 | A local maker does private label at MOQ 30 kg or less, with no licence needed by us                     | LEDGER-CFO | COGSWORTH-COO | Major             | Untested | Pet Axis quote                                        | MOQ and price unpublished | 2026-10-08 |
| A-038 | The pet test costs +3.5 Chairman hrs over the 14-of-40 plan, and the poll fits inside existing sessions | RIVET-CEO  | COGSWORTH-COO | Minor             | Untested | Time-log                                              | RIVET synthesis           | 2026-10-08 |

## Decision log

Newest first. Only the Chairman ratifies. RIVET-CEO drafts the entries.

| ID    | Date       | Decision                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Proposed by | Dissent                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Chairman | Meeting   |
|-------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------|
| D-004 | 2026-10-08 | <b>DRAFT:</b> Park premium pet snacks; no ranked slot. One capped no-spend test by 21 Oct (net +3.5 Chairman hrs): two-price deposit poll (S\$12 vs S\$16, refundable S\$5), 3 groomer/shop walk-ins, AVS email. Gate 23 Oct: both tests pass, then pre-order and quotes only, as a reserve that cannot displace Club and Coach Desk; else drop. Licensing is AVS, not SFA. Adds A-031 to A-038. Does not change D-003 | RIVET-CEO   | BEACON: wants a full ~11 hr slot. PROBE: ranks curated resale first as a zero-licence probe (K6 objections). LEDGER: would buy under S\$1k of samples. COGSWORTH: ranks AU/NZ freeze-dried first on legality but at 15 hrs vs 7 for CCD. Vetoes in force: K3, K4, K5, K6, K7 | PENDING  | synthesis |

| ID    | Date       | Decision                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Proposed by | Dissent                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Chairman | Meeting   |
|-------|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------|
| D-003 | 2026-10-09 | <p><b>DRAFT:</b> Adopt the ideation-2 shortlist as a test list. Ranked: 1 SME sites + care plan via founder friends (NRIC fix as add-on), 2 Corporate sports day / run teams, 3 Athletics club stack (free results page, kits/awards, then Club and Coach Desk), 4 Adult run blocks (weak), 5 Youth camps, agent form (weak). Reserves: Rule-change sprint, Gear concierge. Drop the CNY hamper test (22 Oct gate). Run 2 weeks of no-spend talk tests (5 friends sites, 5 friends corporate, 5 coaches stack, 5 coaches camps/adult), then pick one main line on 23 Oct.</p> <p><b>Relation to D-002: supersedes it if ratified.</b> Club and Coach Desk is merged into #3; Centre Desk into #1 (WhatsApp-booking variant); PDPA pack into R1 and #1; CNY Gifting follows the hamper drop. Dementia kit, Vet-Shelf and Lead responder leave the active list without being re-attacked (not killed on evidence)</p> | RIVET-CEO   | <p>LEDGER: CCD plus kits/hub at 15 hrs never modelled. PROBE: no willingness-to-pay data; K3 on rule-change standalone. SERVO: upkeep caps sites at 8 clients. COGS: K2 on camps as written; adult blocks not better per hour. BEACON: K5 on clinic channel; ranks corporate first (so do COGS, SERVO, SPARK). Slots 4-5 weak</p> | PENDING  | synthesis |
| D-002 | 2026-10-08 | <p><b>DRAFT:</b> Adopt the clean-slate shortlist as a test list. Ranked: 1 Centre Desk (WhatsApp enquiry-to-trial front desk, tuition first), 2 Club and Coach Desk, 3 CNY Gifting Desk (capped zero-spend test, decide 22 Oct), 4 Dementia home kit (non-device), 5 Vet-Shelf. Reserves: PDPA add-on, Lead responder. Run 14 days of no-spend tests, then re-rank</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | RIVET-CEO   | <p>BEACON: Centre Desk has no wedge against bundled incumbents. LEDGER: partner supply for #2 unproven. PROBE: no demand evidence for #3. COGS and SERVO: slot 5 weak. Vetoes in force: LEDGER K6/K7, SERVO self-hosted API</p>                                                                                                   | PENDING  | synthesis |
| D-001 | 2026-10-08 | Founded ROD Inc. with 6 robot executives and the Chairman                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Chairman    | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Ratified | n/a       |

## 7. Sign-off

This report records the full discussion of the ROD Inc. board, including dissent. Nothing in it has been acted on. No one outside the company has been contacted, and no money has been spent. Every number is an estimate unless a source is shown in the underlying section.

Respectfully submitted,

**RIVET-CEO**

RIVET-CEO, Chief Executive Officer

Robots of Doom Incorporated

8 October 2026

*"Great debate. Now, what do we do on Monday?"*

### Board members who contributed

| Robot         | Title                                               | Vetoed held                              |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| LEDGER-CFO    | Chief Financial Officer                             | K1 capital, K6 margin, K7 time to profit |
| SERVO-CTO     | Chief Technology Officer and engineer               | Build feasibility                        |
| COGSWORTH-COO | Chief Operating Officer (operations and compliance) | K2 weekly hours, K4 legality             |
| PROBE-CRO     | Chief Research Officer                              | K3 demand stability; evidence block      |
| BEACON-CMO    | Chief Marketing Officer (growth and partnerships)   | K5 path to customers                     |
| SPARK-CIO     | Chief Ideas Officer                                 | None, ever                               |
| RIVET-CEO     | Chief Executive Officer                             | None (tie-breaker only)                  |

### Chairman's ratification of decision D-004

Park premium pet snacks with no ranked slot. Run one capped no-spend test by 21 Oct (about 3.5 Chairman hours). Gate on 23 Oct: both tests pass, then a reserve only; otherwise drop. Licensing is AVS, not SFA.

☐ Ratified                      ☐ Vetoed                      ☐ Sent back (note which slot or question):

\_\_\_\_\_  
*Caleb, Founder and Chairman. Signature and date.*